

BOOK FOUR
SINNER



Devil
IN THE **WATERS**

KT MORRISON

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Devil In The Waters

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About the Author

KT Morrison writes stories about women who fall in love with sexy men who aren't their husband, and loving relationships that go too far—couples who open a mysterious door, then struggle to get it closed as trouble pushes through the threshold.

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SINNER

A Devil In The Waters Novella

Book 4

34,500 words

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Introduction

A few months ago I began a Patreon. It's a website where creators can garner support from their fans who wish to be patrons.

The aim of my Patreon is to help support the quicker finishing of series' I have still left hanging, and in return I offer a frequent-update series appearing first on Patreon where all the patrons analyze and debate every character's actions and motivations—it's grown to a great and active little community . . .

for more info:

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I

Monday, August 10

Communication

The power was in her hands, quite literally. She didn't know if that made her want to laugh or cry. Sometimes over the last twelve hours it was both.

What she'd done to Josh yesterday made her feel guilty. It was a direct and purposeful manipulation of her sweet husband. A way for her to get away with the things she'd done.

There were times during this escapade between her and Josh and Devlin that had become so complicated she thought she might go out of her mind. There was so much she cherished with Josh. So much she cherished with her husband, that she'd used that as an excuse to foster support to her adventure working for a man neither of them wanted in their lives. Only, she hid a secret from Josh. At least now she admitted it: She wanted Devlin in her life.

As much as she hated Devlin telling her how he knew what she wanted, it turned out he was right. She wanted him. Wanted him for one thing. One thing, one time. So she'd wrapped cotton around her badness, like an armor of soft padding so she could pinball her way through the safety and security of her marriage without either of them getting hurt. For one dirty thing. It was terrible. Lies, all lies, told to a man she respected and adored. And yesterday she'd resorted to sexual manipulation. And frankly, Kimmy, be honest with yourself: it wasn't really the first time you'd resorted to it.

She lay in bed bathed in morning light, her back to her husband's front. A wonderful afternoon yesterday once the cork had popped off their bottle of tension. A wonderful night with him, too. But that weird thing she'd done with her hand came out of nowhere. Using Josh's erection like a joystick to

control his movements. Not the physical ones, but the movements of his mind. Guiding his Player-Character away from her game's dark corners where he might stumble onto the truth.

She stared at her hand, curled on the pillow next to her face. It had worked . . .



Last night they'd gone out on a date. Went to this new Brazilian steakhouse in town and they ate too much. But they laughed and talked. Not about work, though. Well, not about her work. Not about Stone Brokerage. They talked about Swanson and talked about strategies moving forward that might get him attention. She knew he was already well-liked and competent, but his savvy wife had some good suggestions.

At first they backed out of drinks because they were stuffed, and thought they'd go see a movie, but ended up instead driving around in her new eco-conscious car looking at houses in subdivisions, talking about things they liked, things they wanted, laughing at things they didn't like when they did see them. The fun had been completely unprovoked.

It was Kimmy's decision to look at houses. It was togetherness she wanted. They were a couple again. He told her how much he hated being mad and she said she hated the feeling too, hated walking around all day hardly talking. Then they ended up at the Dragon again, went inside and had some whiskies at the end of the bar.

After that they came home and watched TV together, cuddled on the couch. And though Kimmy'd been perverted in the afternoon, doing that weird thing for him, they never did have sex. But that was fine. They fell asleep around ten o'clock on the couch, woke up together and found their bed around midnight. He'd woken up with her this morning in bed spooned against him.

Now he was making them both breakfast, hoping they'd eat together at the table before leaving for work, his ambitious omelette failing and becoming scrambled eggs and peppers instead.

"Hey," Kimmy said, coming from the bedroom to the kitchen pass-through, head down, looking hassled, going through her purse.

"Morning," he said.

She was showered and dressed for work; suit jacket, shirt buttoned right up, all business with her hair pulled back in a bun. Purse plopped on the counter, she had her phone now and was texting. He plated their breakfasts as she came into the kitchen, stocking feet in her cozy slippers. She glanced up from texting and did a double-take seeing his eggs, smiling then and tucking her phone into her jacket pocket. "Aw, Josh, did you make me breakfast?"

"No big deal," he said. "It was supposed to be an omelette . . ."



Before Josh had a chance to take a bite of his breakfast, she lay a hand over his. When he glanced up, she said, "Look, we need to talk more, right?—I'm probably going to be late tonight. Are you going to be okay with that?"

Josh sat poised, contemplating, a forkful of scrambled eggs held up midpoint from plate to his mouth. His eyes drifted over her shoulder, out the window, back to hers. He nodded. "Okay," he said, then took a bite of his eggs.

She watched him chew, patted his hand, picked up her fork and took a bite for herself.

Josh wiped his mouth with a napkin, said, "Why are you going to be late?"

She hummed while she chewed, coming up with an answer. She'd hoped he wouldn't pursue it. Hoped that her honesty would be enough. But Josh held his crumpled napkin in a hand and waited for her to finish chewing. She put a hand over her mouth, saying, "Have to meet some clients after work. Maybe they're coming in from the airport or something, I don't know."

"Why do you say the airport?"

"Oh, I don't . . . Because it's not . . . we're meeting them downtown."

"Where downtown?"

Shoot. She thought the honesty would be easier. And she couldn't lie. So she said, "Right downtown. We're meeting at the Royal York," hoping that wouldn't bother him. Josh knew the Royal York was a hotel. But surely the clients were staying there, he'd think, so she said no more before she suggested too much and sounded suspicious. That is what she thought: the clients were coming in from the airport, probably from China, but staying in the city.

She waited for more questions, and Josh said nothing. Put another forkful of eggs in his mouth.



It bothered him that she was going to be late tonight. Bothered him that she would have a meeting after work hours. But he knew her job wasn't like his job. Not a 9-to-5. Billable hours and all that. She made more money than he did, and it came with obligations. He wouldn't hold that against her. But it still bothered him. He racked dishes in the dishwasher, cleaned the pan where he'd ruined the omelette, dried his hands. Kimmy returned from the bedroom, all ready for work now. She was going through her purse at the pass-through saying, "So what're you going to do tonight, baby?"

“I don’t know,” he said, “I’ll come up with something.”

“Go out for dinner,” she suggested, smiling, “or get Meyer and Steve to come over. You guys can play video games . . .”

“Maybe I’ll do that,” he said.

Whatever it was she searched for in her purse was abandoned. She looked up, both hands still in her purse, nodding at him, lips pursed in a half-smile. She zipped closed her purse, then slung it over her shoulder. She was taller, and he knew the slippers were gone and she’d put her feet into high-heeled shoes now. She said, “Have fun tonight. I’m sorry I won’t be home. I don’t think it’s a regular thing.”

And he had to ask: “Devlin will be there?”

She nodded. Then she said, “I don’t know who all’s going to be there. It won’t just be me, I imagine. But yes, Devlin will be there. You’re still okay?”

“Work is work,” he said, putting on a brave face.

She held his gaze for a few beats, then smiled. “That’s really good, Josh. Okay, I’m gonna go . . .”

He nodded, met her in the foyer and kissed her goodbye. In her heels she was practically the same height as him, and he ushered her to the door, held it and let her walk out. He stuck his head in the hall to see her move down the hallway to the elevator bank. Looking good, looking professional. All black suit, black high-heeled shoes, and smoky stockings . . .

He closed the door, stood in the foyer by himself with his hands on his hips, staring at the photo of the Lungshan Temple. Slightly askew, he leaned over the table and straightened it. Then looked to the table where Devlin’s card had been stored.

If Kimmy put the card there—and if he was to believe she was telling the truth—then who else would know she’d done that? How could anyone

know where she'd put his dumb business card? Would Kimmy have said to Devlin if he asked if she had his card: Yeah, I put it in the table in my front hall? No one would say that. They'd say, Yes, I have your card. Why would Kimmy lie about how the card got there?—because Devlin had really been here. Here in his apartment, and Kimmy'd fucked him. Fucked Devlin before she ever started working for him. Maybe fucked him at the party, too. That's why she took the job. Took it to be close to Devlin.

He was running out of excuses for his wife. Running low on the fuel that ran his engine of trust.

And something occurred to him. A sudden icicle dripping down the back of his throat and freezing his heart.

Chewing his cheek, he made his way to the bedroom now, heart thudding. Right into the closet, opening all the drawers, not finding what he was looking for. Knew exactly where it should be. He'd seen it there already.

Out into the bedroom, checking the other drawers, checking the hamper. Moving fast.

He darted to the bedroom window, getting on his knees on the chair and peeking down to the parking lot. Kimmy out there, strutting in high heels to her new car. Looking confident. Independent. Like his Kimmy, but a woman separate from their relationship. One who was intimidating. Beautiful, smart, making lots of money. The way she should be. Not stuck in this apartment making baskets for people who love their cats too much.

But it was what she wore that stabbed dread into his heart. Those smoky stockings. Part of the lingerie set.

Her kimono hung on the back of the bathroom door, but the lingerie was gone. Bra, high scoop-bottom panties, garter belt and garters, and thigh-high stockings. Kimmy was wearing them. He was sure. Sure his wife had worn that special elegant lingerie today knowing she had a late night meeting at the Royal York—a hotel—with Devlin fucking Stone . . .

Clockwork

Six o'clock now, and she walked the pale marble of the Royal York's lobby dressed all in black and wearing new heels she'd bought for eight hundred dollars this afternoon. They clicked on the transition from the grand hotel's hall where it met the stone floor of the Clockwork. Heads turned at the sound and she flinched, hating the attention the sound high heels brought. Then changed her mind and enjoyed the following gaze of a few well-dressed men sitting in lounge chairs and on couches.

The Clockwork was the lobby's reservation-only luxury lounge. A long and narrow space with high ceilings, the fixtures and decor recalled the hotel's railway history. At the back, the bar stood below two very tall racks of back-lit shelving lined with liquor. At the top of the bar's towering shelves, a train station clock showed the little hand on the six, big hand past twelve. The barman dressed in black and white; the tables were low, seats comfortable and upholstered in fine fabrics; the seating spaces were intimate and softly lit. Devlin sat in the center on a couch by himself, one leg crossed over the other. He watched her come to him.

She didn't smile, didn't give him any expression but the poker face she reserved for court. But her insides squirmed in awful anticipation. She wore no panties under her skirt.

Stopped couch-side, she looked mildly at their seating—two opposing sofas in amber velvet—said, “Our guests haven't arrived yet?”

“Not yet,” Devlin said, then patted the sofa, “come sit with me.”

When the guests did arrive, they would sit together opposite them, so she tucked her skirt behind her thighs and sat next to Devlin on the couch,

putting her purse on her lap. Phone from her pocket, she shut it off and put it in her bag, set the bag on the floor. “What are you having?” she asked, nodding her chin to the cocktail on the table in front of him.

“Whisky cocktail. Foreign Exchange. I’ll order you one.” He signaled for a server and she crossed her legs, putting her back into the sofa’s corner.

Devlin’s eyes moved up and down her stocking leg from knee to foot. “I love the new shoes, Kimmy,” he said. Then the server was there before she could comment, and he ordered for her what he was drinking.

She said, “Are our guests running late? How long do we wait?”

Devlin checked his watch. “They’ll be along soon. You’re anxious to get home?”

“It’s been a long day.”

“Mel’s shipment still rotting on the dock?”

“I’ve made headway,” she said.

“Tell me about it.”

“I’ll wait till it’s confirmed.”

He raised an eyebrow. “That’s exciting, Kimmy. ABM said they hit a roadblock.”

She nodded but offered nothing more.

Her drink arrived. She sipped, and Devlin watched her.

“What do you think?”

“I think you’ve made me like whisky. What’s in there—cherry?”

He nodded. “Maraschino liqueur.”

She checked her watch. “This isn’t going to sound crazy—because I know you—but I get the feeling there are no guests coming.”

He chuckled softly, brushed his pant leg, then set his cocktail back down. “And yet you came.”

“You said it was for work.”

“You bought new shoes.”

She flexed her foot so she could eye her new purchase. “I saw them, I liked them, I bought them,” she said.

“You’re chillier than I expected.”

“I’ll warm up when the guests arrive.”

“They’ll be here soon,” he said, “drink up.”

She sipped her cocktail again; spice, whisky, cherry. It burned, it was sweet and smoky, and she liked it. Liked sitting here too. Sitting here in a luxury hotel with everyone wondering who this beautiful couple was sitting in a space reserved for four, standing out in their black clothes and their sharp and commanding features. Devlin wore a suit in black with a thin chalky stripe; white shirt with French cuffs, silk tie in azure and knotted perfectly. The watch he wore today was gold to match his cuff links. Hair slicked back and face shaved, he looked devilish and powerful; like he belonged here. She wore her best suit, also in black. Hose and garter belt, her lingerie bra. She’d worn the matching panties, then in the car in the underground she’d stripped them off and hid them under her seat. What the hell for, she didn’t know. But she’d worn them all day, and they’d be pungent, and even though there wasn’t a chance Devlin would have been putting his hand in them tonight, she felt funny about it. Then walking in the chill of the underground, her stomach had tightened with the thrill of meeting with her awful boss without them on.

She set her cocktail on the table. “Look, Devlin. I hope you remember when you said anything between us wasn’t part of my employment.”

He nodded, waiting.

“Because . . . I can’t.”

He showed her his palms, shrugged. “Never say never.”

“I talked to Josh this weekend.”

He smirked. “Did he find our texts?”

She scoffed at the awful thought. “No. But we just . . . talked.”

“What did he say?”

She looked around the bar, watched people having much easier conversations by lamp light, laughing, smiling, leaning close. This would be much nicer if she were here with Josh and they were having a good time. “I remember you had a reputation in high school—”

“For what?”

“For being a bully. And Josh . . . told me you weren’t very nice to him.”

Devlin didn’t object, moved his eyes around like this news was already obvious. “No, I probably wasn’t.”

She waited a long beat, and he waited along with her. “It makes me uncomfortable.”

Devlin nodded again, watching her, contemplating. He leaned to take his cocktail, sipped, held it on his knee. “Kimmy, no one wants to relive high school. Not me, despite what people might think about guys like me. Everybody assumes to guys like me they’re the glory days . . . I know they’re not. I’ll tell you, I’m a million miles away from that guy I was in high school. I’m not like that anymore. Guys like Josh want me to be. They can’t get away from it. Look at you. Are you like you were in high school?”

“What was I like in high school?”

He flashed a smile. “Blunt?”

“The truth.”

“I didn’t notice you. I didn’t know your name. Well, I knew it was Kimmy. But you were just a skinny Chinese girl who knew all the answers. Got hundred-percents. Never, ever saw you out of school. What do I think of you now?”

“I didn’t ask. You’ve already told me what you thought of me now.”

“Right. That proves my point, doesn’t it?”

She averted her eyes to her skirt’s hem. “Maybe.”

“Are you that same girl from high school?”

“No.”

“You wear khaki pants and pastel sweaters with fucking bunnies and shit on them.”

She chuckled. She’d like to. “Sometimes I like to be comfortable.”

Now Devlin smiled and eased closer. She realized she’d given him some room. He said, “Tell me this: Did that skinny stick from high school ever think she could be the kind of woman who’d put on an expensive black dress, thousand dollar shoes, fucking walk in a room like this and get every man looking? Make a man like me swallow hard, get his dick hard, make him work overtime coming up with ways to get you upstairs and into a hotel room. Did she ever think she could be like that?”

She hummed in her throat, scratched her neck, looked around again. “No.”

He smiled. “That shy girl—who was so fucking pretty, but so fucking nerdy—the one Amy brought to my house telling me she thought we could get her in bed, would she ever believe the things we’ve already done?”

She shook her head. “Definitely not.”

“You wanted to that night.”

She laughed. “With you and Amy?—I did not.”

“You did. You did, but you were scared.”

She rolled her eyes. “So what?”

“Amy picked you. She swore you’d go for it.

“But I didn’t . . . I wasn’t your choice?”

“I kinda knew who she meant when she told me. I was happy when you showed up.”

She chuckled—surprised she could chuckle over the awful event that had shaken her teenage life. An event she’d distressed over for years afterward. How could Amy do that to her . . .? Did the hottest guy in high school actually think she was worthy . . .? A year of reeling from one side to the other: insult and regret. “I had no idea what Amy wanted me there for.”

“You ran.”

“I did.”

“I don’t think you’d run from me now.”

“I’m not running. I’m not afraid. It’s Josh. It’s what you did to my husband when we were younger . . . and . . . what he says you’re doing now.”

Devlin frowned, puzzled. “What am I doing now?”

She rubbed at her temple: the first break in her stony demeanor. She corrected it. “That Double-A stuff is just dumb and mean—”

“That was back in high school.”

“You were saying it to me and Amy at Tiffany’s party, and you said it in my apartment.”

He chuckled. “It is dumb. You’re right. I wouldn’t say it to Josh’s face, if that would make you feel better.”

“It’s still juvenile.”

“Your husband was— Never mind . . .”

“Say it.”

“He started it.”

She grunted, frowned. “Called himself Double-A?”

“No-no, I started that, or one of the other guys. It started because . . . he was checking out my piece in the shower. I’m an asshole. Sorry. But, Kimmy, I called him that when I was thirteen. You know how stupid thirteen-year-old boys are?—really stupid. And mean.”

“I don’t care, Devlin,” she said. “That’s just . . . you left your card in my front hall table.” She met his eyes.

He nodded, waiting for the bad part.

She said, “Then you texted Josh to let him know it was there.”

He shook his head like he’d been told something impossible. “I did what?”

“You texted him it was there so he’d know you were in our apartment.”

“I certainly did not,” he said, amused, “Josh told you that?”

“You did,” she said, but the whole while gauging his reaction, springing it on him in a calculated move. And unless he’d prepared his response in the mirror, it seemed genuine surprise.

“I don’t even know Josh’s number,” he said, looking around the lounge, his expression tickled—like he’d realized her barrier to sleeping with him was some lie her husband had told her about him, and that barrier was made of cardboard. “Why would I do that?”

“He says to fuck with him.”

Devlin struggled with an answer for a moment, still gladdened by her accusation. “Kimmy, I’m not the guy I was. You’re not that girl. Josh is stuck there. Can’t get his brain out of the last decade. Don’t let him hold himself back. Let him grow up. And for sure don’t let him hold you back.”

“He doesn’t hold me back, ever. He supports me.”

“Look at me,” he said, expression going serious, “I did not text Josh I was in your apartment. Why the hell would I do that? I want it a secret more than you.”

“More than me?”

He laughed. “I want to fuck you more than you want to fuck me.”

She scoffed, but a shiver got her shoulders shaking and nipples tightening hearing him say fuck. “Right,” she said, but was thinking maybe he wasn’t kidding. “Then how did Josh know the card was there?”

“Jesus, Kimmy. You’re the smart one. Josh found it. Then made up a story about how he found it.”

It was what she’d worried. Poor Josh. “Why would you leave it there?”

“For you.”

“You left it where anyone could find it. Like my husband.”

“I put it to the side where no one would see it. I wait three days, if I don’t hear from you, I text and tell you to look in the drawer . . .”

“Like a dumb magic trick.”

“Not everything I come up with is a winner.”

“It was dumb and risky and you must have known there would be a chance Josh would find it.”

He flicked his eyes away, looked back. “Careless, yes. On purpose, no. If I wanted to fuck with Josh, he’d know about it. There would be no mystery. I don’t think about Josh. I think about you.”

“It could have jeopardized my marriage.”

“I admit it was careless.”

“If anything I do harms my husband, it’s untenable. If you bully him—or have someone else do it—I’m out. Out of Stone, too.”

“Kimmy, Josh is just jealous. Jealous of you spending time with me, jealous you make way more money than him now. He’s stuck in high school. You know it. I’m an asshole, yes. But I’ve got better things to do . . . I left high school ten years ago, if I had time for games like that I’d need my head examined. Josh is trying to pull you back, and he’s making up crazy shit because he doesn’t know any better way to deal with problems.”

She looked away, twisting her mouth around. Somewhere along the way, she’d crossed her arms.

Devlin said, “You know that makes more sense than what Josh told you.”

“I thought about it.”

Devlin asked her: “Do you think power is infinite?”

“What are you calling power?”

“This imaginary force you think one exerts over another.”

“Infinite? No.”

“Then it’s finite.”

“Yes.” She shrugged a shoulder. “So?”

“Is it tangible? Can it be possessed?”

“Sure. It can be possessed. No. Not tangible.”

“If it’s not tangible how can one possess it?”

“I don’t know,” she said, letting out an agitated exhale. “It’s talk like this that got us fighting last time. Is that your plan?—pin me down on the floor here . . . Okay, how does one possess power then?”

He said, “Power is granted.”

She said, “Power is a privilege.”

“Is it? Maybe, but not in the way you think.”

“What the hell are you talking about here?”

“Giving me the label of bully to place blame, to hang it on my shoulders, is as imprecise as labelling Josh a victim. It’s only labels. It’s not truth. Josh and I exchanged energy. The victim draws the bully in, not the other way around. Sometimes someone’s soft energy inspires aggression.”

“He doesn’t ask for it.”

“All due respect: his behavior asks for it.”

She huffed and rolled her eyes again.

“Josh grants the power. The power is bestowed by the weak. Josh’s weakness draws its own response. His weakness can draw the nurturer, like you, or it can draw the dominant like me. Either way, Josh is the one signaling for a response. Darkness isn’t the opposite of light, it’s the absence of light. Cold is the absence of heat. Weakness is the absence of power. And like cold will draw heat, Josh’s weakness will draw strength. When I see weakness I am pulled to it. I don’t seek out weakness out of arrogance or bullying, but when I encounter it, my reaction is magnetic. I’m pulled to it, to quash it, to fill power’s absence.”

“Very philosophical. And nonsense.”

“If Josh didn’t want to be bullied, he shouldn’t let himself be bullied.”

“So he wants to be bullied?”

“No. He doesn’t. But I bullied him. Me and others. When we were young. And that’s the way Josh set up his mental office. All his drawers and shelves are lined up and organized to deal with how others interact with him. How he handles you, how he handles work . . . even the pleasure signals in his brain are all arranged to cope with his fears.”

She sat for a long time not saying anything and actually contemplating his ridiculous philosophy.

Devlin asked: “Why are you smirking—what are you thinking about?”

She chuckled, playing with her earlobe, looking away, then back to him. “When I went home after the day we spent in Hamilton—you know, in the cargo container—I was so worried, I was shaking. Worried I’d get caught, and I’d hurt him. But then . . .”

“Yeah?”

“Then . . . when it was obvious I got away with it, I . . . I’d been worried he’d smell sex in my hair, but when I got away with it, I asked him . . .”

Devlin’s features were anxious, leaning close. “Go on . . .”

“I asked him to smell my hair.” She scrunched her nose and then laughed. It’d been an awful thing to do—but it had been so exciting.

Instead of laughing, Devlin leaned back, tugged his pant leg, shifted, his mouth hidden behind a hand, playing with his lip, thinking, shaking his head. “That’s so hot, Kimmy.” His voice was a low, dry grumble.

“It was awful. Not hot. Awful.”

“Why did you do it then?”

“I don’t even know. It was like . . . I knew he didn’t suspect, and I . . . I couldn’t believe he didn’t suspect it. How could he not? I asked him to smell my hair—for fertilizer—when earlier in the night if he came near me, I was so scared he’d smell sex that I wanted to run out of the room. Once I knew I got away with it . . .”

“You liked rubbing it in his face?”

“God, no. Oh, no way. Do you think that’s what I mean? No. I don’t know what it was, but putting it under his nose and he couldn’t tell . . .?”

“Kimmy the thrill-seeker.”

“Maybe,” she laughed. “That’s what it was: thrilling. That’s exactly how it felt.”

“You like getting away with it.”

She nodded. “I don’t want him to know, I don’t want to hurt him, but, yes, I loved getting away with it.”

“He drew that out of you. When he’s weak, his wife is strong.”

She rolled her eyes. Devlin smiled, mean, eyes narrowed.

“Well,” she said, “that brings us back to start. No guests coming. No texts from guests while we’re waiting, saying they’re almost here. You haven’t checked your watch, haven’t checked your phone. You brought me here for one thing.”

“I did.” He looked at her without apology.

“Josh lied to me about some text from you because he does suspect it now. He’s worried. I don’t want to hurt him. I love him.”

“He doesn’t have to know.”

“I’ll know, Devlin. I can’t. I know-I know, I want to, you don’t have to tell me, but I can’t do it. I think I have to go.”

She picked up her purse, stood and slung it over a shoulder. Devlin held her wrist before she could walk away. She waited to hear what he'd say.

“You'll arouse him when you're bad.”

The thought leaked into her brain and flipped her stomach. Her knees weakened—but she shook her head no. “I'm not bad.”

“You are, and Josh knows it.”

“No, he doesn't,” she said, and tugged her arm back. “Maybe I'll see you tomorrow,” she said, and walked around the couch and out to the lobby without looking back. But it was in the wide open space of the marble concourse, where her clicking heels disappeared amongst all the other footsteps and voices of the busy hotel, that she felt the soggiess between her legs. Her thighs stroked against each other like they were oiled. The whole time with Devlin, with his arrogance and masculine charm, she'd fought off her desire for him. Somehow, when he'd talked about Josh, she'd grown more deeply aroused.

She stopped a moment and stood in place, pretending to look for her phone, but actually flexing her thighs together to test the mess. Could she have wetted the back of her skirt? Hand behind her, she tugged the tail of her suit jacket, satisfied it would probably cover.

There were cushioned seats lined around the base of a square marble column, and she rested there a moment, gathering herself; inhaling deep, exhaling like she would before a yoga class. She hugged the purse to her stomach and people-watched for a few minutes before she slumped, forearms on her knees, eyes on the marble floor.

When she raised them again a motionless man on the other side of the lobby got her attention. Devlin standing there and watching her, people moving around him, one woman looking back to admire him. Tall, dark, handsome, well-dressed, sexy, hung. In his hand he held a key card. No gesture made to her now, he simply turned and walked deeper into the Royal York. She watched him go, gently beating fists on her knees. Then she rose, slung her purse, turned around and headed to the underground parking. Turned around

again, stopped, turned back. Decided, she turned around one more time and passed through the lobby, walking under the art déco chandeliers and past the huge concierge desk and down the hall alongside the Clockwork, headed to the elevator bank. Devlin stood regarding the numbers on the panel waiting for an elevator cab to arrive. She stood next to him. He looked to her and smiled, looked back to the descending numbers. When the elevator doors opened, she got in first, Devlin gesturing for her to go ahead.

Skyscraper Canyon

His current rationalization: If Kimmy was fucking Devlin, then why would she need to meet Devlin at a hotel after work? Devlin was her boss, so he could tell her to knock off for an extra-long lunch and they'd hook up for an afternoon delight. The reason then that Devlin would take her out after work was because he wanted Josh to know: Josh, I have your wife after work. That's your time, buddy. But it's my time now. Yeah, I could fuck her at lunch, but I need you to know I'm fucking her . . .

But why no more contact? Why no more taunting texts then?

This situation had finally twisted him to his snapping point. There were times he could ignore what was going on because he didn't believe it. Didn't believe Kimmy would ever cheat on him. But all day today Kimmy and Devlin were all he could think of. And self-hatred. Hating himself for letting it get to this point.

He buzzed down his window and breathed fresh air. It wasn't fresh. He was in a shaded untraveled canyon-like roadway running a circuit between skyscrapers. Parked next to a yellow parking barrier by a black-painted cement wall, the air that came through the window was hot like exhaust from the buildings' air conditioners. He did the window back up and rotated his head on his aching neck.

This was really happening, wasn't it? He was starting to believe Kimmy was actually sleeping with Devlin. For the longest time, he'd parted Kimmy from the formula. It was between him and Devlin, and Devlin used her as a pawn. Somehow he'd sexualized the fear, enjoyed it, let that weird pleasure strain his better judgment and permit his wife getting closer to Devlin—

when he should have kept them apart. But up till this morning he hadn't believed it was true. This morning was the first time he had real evidence. As real as it was. Maybe she sent the lingerie to the dry cleaner. He'd googled 'lingerie' at work, and yes, some women sent lingerie to the dry cleaner. He didn't go home and tear the apartment apart looking for her pickup stub to prove it to himself, but just thinking that's where the lingerie might be calmed him down enough he could function.

Why couldn't he commit to proving himself right or wrong, once and for all? Instead, here he was half-hearted, non-committed—fucking flaccid—skulking in an upscale alley in the vicinity of the Royal York. If he was a real man, he'd march right into the Royal York, sit down with them all and make his presence known.

Shit, no. That was stupid.

What then?

That was the problem: he didn't even know. How does one deal with this? He'd always been cushioned by the thought that his wife would never cheat on him. Ever. And even though never was never, the added enforcement of her fidelity would be that—on top of it never happening—it especially would never be with Devlin Stone.

Slumped low in his driver seat, tie loosened, shirt unbuttoned, hair a mess, he watched a technician unloading gear from his Bell van at a building's service entrance; in his lap his phone's screen showed Kimmy's throbbing blue dot on the Find My Phone app so close to his own. She was just around the corner. He could go and spy, go see who the clients were (if there were any), see what she looked like sitting with Devlin. Fuck, that would hurt though. That scared the shit out of him. For what if her lingerie was at the dry cleaner and he was wrong once again and the woman he trusted was working and not having an affair? If he got caught he'd be embarrassed at the worst. But equally worst was not getting caught and catching a real live glimpse of what his beautiful wife looked like sitting and having drinks with his high school bully. Kimmy in her new and foreboding dark lawyer clothes, hair pulled back, looking severe and scary and sexy, and she's with

the guy who told everyone in school Josh was gay for looking at his dick in the shower. He'd have that image burned in his head forever.

Probably go back to not getting it up for her, Josh. Remember that after Tiffany's party? When you were so scared of Devlin's big dick your smaller dick stayed down and cowered before your wife. You'd thought she'd had sex with Devlin those days. You want to go back there?

Just some lingerie. That's what started this. Maybe the smoky stockings she wore this morning were just panty hose that looked the same. Maybe the lingerie was out of the house being cleaned . . .

Maybe.

But you wouldn't get stockings dry cleaned, would you?

"Fuck," he hissed and thumped the heel of his hand on the steering wheel.



Devlin had booked a suite in anticipation he would get her into bed. Seventeenth floor, lake side of the building, windows looking out over the Scotiabank Arena and the Inner Harbour beyond. The coffered walls were a subdued dove gray; the furniture austere but reminiscent of vintage rail travel, modern and black with gold trim, swayed legs like what occidentals would have called oriental—a banker's minimalist version of the Orient Express.

They walked together to the center of the hotel room's living room, and Devlin asked her if she'd like another drink. She appreciated the distraction. The hesitation. The momentary pulsing of the brakes on this awful thing she was going to do. Because she was going to do it now.

So why stop for a drink?

“Yes, please.”

“Whiskey, right?”

She smiled, said, “You know me well.”

Devlin chuckled, strolled to a low smoky glass-and-steel table by the window looking out on the sunny waterfront. On the table there were bottles of liquor arranged on a tray, and Devlin looked through them, produced one and showed it to her. But she didn’t really know whiskeys, so she just nodded. He poured a glass while she stood in the room with her hands together at her front. Earlier this evening feeling so dominant, but now suddenly feeling very submissive despite her stern and proud attire.

Devlin returned with one glass and presented it to her.

She asked, “You’re not having one?”

He shook his head no, put his hands in his pants pockets like he would watch her drink. She let him watch, smelled the whiskey, took a long sip, then licked her lips while they burned, looked around the luxury suite. She said, “Can we talk about work or something?”

Devlin pulled a hand out of his pocket, checked his gold watch. “Too late to talk about work now, Kimmy. I’m all talked out. And it’s time for play.”

She nodded, licked her lips again, drained her whiskey glass and returned it to him. He took it and smiled, holding it at his chest and studying her. “The way that light is hitting your face right now, Kimmy, I can’t believe how beautiful you grew up to be.”

She tried not to show a reaction. Stared back. Studied the light on his face, imagining how the same light might play on her own. Late summer in the city, later in the day, almost dusk, the sun low and hot orange. The light that came in the windows looked reflected off pink glass. It put warmth on his dark and severe features. The prominent cheekbones, the sharp jaw. It was after six now, but no five o’clock shadow. Devlin had shaved for their

encounter. She was sure of it. He was a masculine man, one that would show stubble.

He was so sure of himself. Inviting her here on a Monday night, two days ago, specifically to get her into the bed behind her. Tricking her. Knowing he could trick her. And he was right. He'd booked the suite. A luxury suite that must cost almost four figures for the night. Made reservations at Clockwork. Had shaved his face. All for her.

She let her purse strap fall from her shoulder, stepped away and plopped it on a chair. Devlin returned the glass to the table and set it down with a quiet click. Turned then, and met her in the middle of the carpet, face-to-face, her looking up at him. He cupped a hand to her neck, lowered his mouth to hers. Their lips came close, but she turned away.

“Don’t . . .”

He gripped her neck, stroked her jaw with his thumb. Then pushed her away with the slightest measure of roughness. It opened her eyes. But he was smiling, looking down on her like he controlled her. He said, “Take off your jacket.”

Blazer unbuttoned, she opened it, her eyes on his as she withdrew her arms then slung it across her purse resting on the chair. Devlin eyed her, looking her up and down, and she stood straight like she expected this inspection and wanted to measure up to his standards. Thought she did, too. He came close again, undid the top button on her shirt, slipped a finger in the open V now and touched the bare skin of her collar.

She put her hands over his, held it. He flattened the palm against her skin. She said, “I’m married.”

In one swift motion, eyes still on hers, Devlin stooped, the hand going from her collar to her waist, lower then, taking the hem of her skirt on one side and pulling it up her thigh.

For the first time, it looked like she had got the better of Devlin.

He hadn't expected to see stockings and garters. No, not from the high school girl who used to wear khaki pants, white sneakers, and, yes, she did have a pale yellow sweater with three bunnies on the front. But what he said at Clockwork was correct: She wasn't that girl anymore. She was the woman Devlin drew out from inside her.

Devlin's face lost that dominant hardness, and she watched his eyes as what he saw genuinely pleased him. She took her lower lip in her mouth, bit it. He lifted the skirt higher, then with his other hand lifted up the front. Found out she wore no panties. She waited for his eyes to return, and when they did she smiled. That domination was gone still, and replaced now with pure male hunger. This was the reason a woman dressed this way. The control she had now felt more amazing than she anticipated. She even tightened her butt muscles, pushed her pelvis forward and widened her stance.

"Touch me," she whispered.

He was going to anyway, and his hand smoothed down between her thighs; she could feel against his fingers and palm how wet she was. Even the insides of her thighs still felt greased. But his touch took away that momentary exchange of power between them. Now Devlin was dominant again, and she was falling against him, her knees turning to water.

He supported her, a hand on the small of her back while he pushed big fingers through her folds, sunk his middle finger inside her. While he fingered her gently, her knees came together till they touched. Then his fingers were gone, slipping up her front, the wetness leaving a trail on her skin through her pubic hair and below her navel. The skirt fell to her thighs, and Devlin touched her lips with the wetness from between her legs.

He said, "Now take off your shirt," and stepped back, still facing her but pulling a chair closer. He motioned with his chin for her to move aside and stand in front of the loveseat at the foot of the bed, a gray upholstered sofa with black trim, the seat padded with harlequin-printed pillows. She centered herself, met his gaze, watched as he sat and crossed a leg. Devlin Stone wanted to watch her undress. She would do that.

Eyes on his, she took her time undoing each button until her shirt hung open. Then exposing one shoulder, the next, letting the shirt trail down her back before flinging it to the loveseat. She stood in her bra and didn't wait for him to ask to remove the skirt. Hands coming together at her side, drawing down the zipper, sucking in her stomach and letting the skirt fall around her ankles. She stepped out of it, not embarrassed for some reason, even standing before Devlin Stone wearing only lingerie and high heels and without panties. Which was insane. Never in her life was she the type of woman she would think could stand like this before a man other than Josh and let him study her body this way. But the man was Devlin Stone, and she wasn't that timid straight-A student from high school anymore. No, she was a grown woman with long legs, a killer job, went to the gym three nights a week and did yoga twice a week at lunch time. And this was what you did that for. To be appreciated. She even turned, showing him three-quarters of her backside, let sexy Devlin Stone see her ass. Yeah, she was skinny, she was long-limbed—but her ass wasn't flat, it was round. She bit her lip, seeing that hunger growing in him, his stern expression glowering at her naked body like he wanted to punish it. Punish it because it was too good to be true. It affected him. And he didn't like to be affected.

She whispered, "What do you think?"

Devlin liked what he saw, keeping his eyes on hers then rising from the seat to cross the space that separated them. She trembled in anticipation, and the closer he came, the more she could feel his presence—a phantasmal approach, his power over her tingling around her before he could even touch her.

He stood tall next to her, still clothed, her in almost nothing. And now she flooded between her legs again, her stomach quivering, but her mind still looking for a way to get out of here.

Voice low, he grumbled, "You're torn, aren't you?"

"Torn?"

She looked in his eyes. They were narrowed on hers, that pinky orange sunlight coming in and filling them with otherworldly light. She nodded.

“You hate how your body betrays you,” he said, his eyes breaking their connection with hers, watching his forefinger trace down her lingerie-clad body. Her body long, lean, one she was proud of, but also now feeling ashamed for showing it to another man so proudly. His fingertips touched across her hipbone and got butterflies lifting in her stomach. Then down, and she knew where it was headed: the angled crease where thigh met groin, coming down and tickling through her pubic hair and touching her pussy. His fingers produced a sopping wet sound. “You hate so much how your body betrays you.”

She whispered, “I want to be home with my husband.”

“But you’re here with me,” he said, and his eyes returned to hers as he slid his middle finger inside her.

She sighed, surrendering to him, body sagging for a moment before she stood upright again. “I’m here with you.”

“You want me so bad,” he said, a smile tugging to one side, eyes like black slits.

“Don’t taunt me.”

“You’re fascinating, Kimmy. I’m not taunting you, I’m getting to understand you . . . getting to know you . . .”

“Getting to know me while your finger’s inside me,” she said, touching his forearm, her hand coming down to hold his wrist steady.

“I’m going to know you, Kimmy. I’m going to know every inch of you. Inside and out. And you’re going to get to know every inch of me.”

She gasped—his incessant waves beating against her retaining wall, crumbling it—then let go his wrist, put her hand flat below his belt, smoothed the fine wool of his fly downward until she felt the bulk of his

manhood behind the fabric. No underwear, hanging heavy down a pant leg. She squeezed and milked downward, stoked and squeezed up and down and cradled his balls through his pants. “God, I’m so awful,” she said, closing her eyes.

“You’re so perfect,” he corrected.

“Perfect to you,” she whined, gripping his huge cock through his pants, “but I’m a horrible human being to the one I love . . .”

“You don’t love him any less.”

“Don’t talk about him . . .”

“I like talking about him,” Devlin said, sneering, his breath on her neck, studying her face as he fingered her. “And you do, too—Sometimes we act like he’s not a part of this, but you know he is. You can’t stop talking about him. Down in Clockwork, letting me know how important he was to you.”

“He is important.”

“Then why can’t you help yourself?”

“You’re talking me out of it,” she said, let his cock go, showed him a more steely gaze.

“Nothing’s going to stop you from doing this, Kimmy. Your tough talk is cute, but I know I’m going to have your legs spread on that bed, and I’m finally going to take what I want . . .”

Now her knees went weak again, and she sagged against his hand. Devlin met her slumping by pushing two fingers inside her and holding her up, pussy in the cup of his hand. He sneered again, loving his effect on her.

How had it come to this? It was a long and sinuous trail that lead back through the hotel room door, down the elevator, through the bar and then zigzagging her life for the last few months. The choice was hers to make. Devlin had given it to her. Devlin didn’t force her into this hotel room, he

only opened the door. It was her stepping through. Her making the decision that could injure the man she loved.

“I just can’t,” she whispered, trying to show him a face that would inspire compassion or mercy from him.

“You say you can’t, but you’re standing here in clothes you wore for me. And you’ve left this bare,” he said, and cupped his hand between her legs again. The stroke of his fingers against her slippery folds got her sighing. “You want me to claim this pussy as mine. You want to give it to me . . .”

“You can make me come again . . .”

“I can,” he said. “But aren’t you tired of playing that game?”

“It’s not a game.”

While his fingers stroked, finding the hard fleshy pearl of her clitoris, teasing it, working circles, he lowered his mouth toward hers again.

She pulled away, but this time his free hand gripped her throat.

He said, “You’re not fighting with me . . .”

“I know,” she moaned, “I’m fighting with me . . .”

“You want this—so take it.”

“I don’t even like you . . .”

“You don’t have to like me . . .”

His fingers probed deeper, and her hands went to hold on to his wrist. “just please—please, make . . . make me come . . .”

“It’s all about you, isn’t it, Kimmy?” He fucked her pussy faster with his two fingers, chuckling in his throat . . .

Lap Of Luxury

The most embarrassing thing that could happen would be running into them. Or being discovered another way: like, just as he checked up on Kimmy using Find My Phone, she could just as easily open up her app and see his pinging blue dot so close to hers when he should be all the way back in Ajax.

And it could happen easily. There was no way for him to protect himself from being discovered that way. He could turn off his visibility, but then what if Kimmy turned off hers as well? Shit, maybe it would be better to be in the dark. Maybe if he were in the dark, instead of lurking outside the Royal York he'd be at home with the guys playing video games and keeping his mind off it, only suffering the occasional bouts of What if? . . .

Now he was sitting on a low concrete wall, hunched over eating a street dog overloaded with sauerkraut and mustard because he was fucking starving. Only, his stomach churned like water around a boat propellor, and he set the dog aside and sipped soda to settle the discomfort. Behind him was the brass doors to the Railway Offices at Union Station, and he hid himself in the passing throngs of commuters, eyes across the street at the grand entrance to the Royal York—but a safe distance away so he wouldn't be detected. Kimmy and Devlin would probably park underground, they wouldn't be on this side of Front Street at all. And they wouldn't come outside at all, either, Josh—what are you even doing here?

Maybe building the nerve to go in. Imagine if you had balls big enough to walk in there, sit down at their table, reach over and take a sip of Devlin's drink before kissing Kimmy and saying, "Just in the area, thought I'd pop by and see how my special lady's doing." What a dork. Right, you'd do that

with all those other guys at the table, coming in with that kind of confidence in your off-the-rack suit you bought at the mall.

The truth was he was his own worst enemy, his fear punishing him more (he hoped) than Kimmy's reality. It might be better for him if he were at home eating pizza and drinking beers, playing Red Dead or Modern Warfare with Steve and Meyer—even if she was cheating with Devlin. Mightn't it? What if Kimmy and Devlin had a fling, and you never knew about it and she never loved you any less and your marriage was never in real jeopardy and the fling with Devlin lasted only a little while and somehow once it was out of her system Kimmy bounced back and loved you more and you guys got even closer than ever? . . . Shit, because things never worked out that way, and, damn it, he wanted to know. Wanted to know more than anything. In fact, in some way it might be better for his mental health to just have it confirmed. Yup, she's having sex with Devlin Stone. Aren't you relieved? Now back to our regular programming . . . He was literally obsessed with confirming it. To the point he didn't even know if there was anything now that would prove to him she wasn't cheating. Not her word, definitely not Devlin's word . . . Then what are you here for—just for the bad news?

If he were here only for the bad news, then something was wrong with him.

Despite the still-persistent hunger, he stood now, crossed to the curbside and trashed the remainder of the hot dog. Didn't matter how much you wanted to eat when your guts were twisted thinking your wife was having an affair with a guy you hated . . . Slurped his orange pop empty, trashed it too. Put hands in pockets, fumbling with keys and then watching back at the Royal York's doors, the awning over the street held up by chains in copper bird's mouths, the copper gone green. Just past those doors there'd be a lounge, and in the lounge his wife sat after work with Devlin Stone—big dick Devlin Stone who'd treated Josh Waters like a human joke. Why would you want to be here? His eyes rolled up as he rubbed his neck—and it was crazy . . . looking up at the hotel made him realize her dot would ping on the map if she were in the lounge, but it would also ping in the same spot if she were underground . . . and it would also ping in the same spot if she were up in one of the rooms getting pounded from behind.

Kimmy'd told him to go out with Meyer, told him to have fun. He said he thought he might do that. What would she think, knowing that instead, he still suspected bad things of her, enough that after work he drove all the way into the city, fighting the traffic, to do what . . .?—Spy on her. Would she be mad? Probably. Maybe he could play it off as being protective. Wanting to look out for his wife. But what if she saw it a different way? What if she saw it closer to what it really was? Fear. Fear and mistrust. What if she was offended he thought she could be sleeping with Devlin? It could backfire that way. Nothing going on between her and his high school bully, all of it concocted in his head by the malicious textual hypnotizing of his bully, the phantom thoughts pushed into his brain and making him mistrust his wife.

Up in one of those rooms, Kimmy right now could be taking a massive cock. Wearing her lingerie, crying out with pleasure, getting fucked by a guy—by all high school accounts—who could wreck a girl. Was it possible?—Yes. Likely?—No. Now he scanned eyes to the left, west along Front Street. He'd parked the Qashqai a block-and-a-half down that way, at a parking lot where you could pay cash—imagined Kimmy looking at the credit card statement and seeing his parking fee near the Royal York on the day she'd gone there with Devlin.

Back to the parking was where he should be walking, but instead he was crossing at the light to get on the northern side of Front, get himself just a little closer to the scene. Maybe he'd be happy to see her in a business meeting. Maybe he'd find her alone with Devlin and that would be something fun and new to worry about. He wouldn't see Devlin fucking her over the table from behind, so what could go wrong? . . .

He chuckled on the other side of the street, hands in pockets, hunched a little so he could try to hide his face in an emergency, knowing full well there was plenty that could go wrong . . .



Devlin's mouth lowered to hers again, wanting to kiss. She showed him her cheek. Only, this time he didn't take her neck or jaw, instead he gripped her throat, his large powerful hand so strong on her slender neck. He thumbed her chin to look up at him while he fucked her with his fingers and her legs went watery. His face loomed close to hers and for the first time since entering the hotel room she pondered her reservation—wondered why she fought him so hard when she knew she wanted it. Knew it would happen. It was like when she was a kid and built the courage to dive off the public pool's highest board. Everyone else'd done it already, and she knew she could, had prepared herself, but the hardest part she'd thought would be climbing the ladder. But it wasn't. It was stepping off the board.

Instead of kissing her, he smiled, let go her chin. His thrusting fingers (and the accompanying wet shucking of her pussy) quit, and the room was silent. She stumbled forward on her heels and he steadied her, got her standing on her own, his hand that braced her weight between her legs withdrew, his fingers sliding out from her insides. She wanted them to return and made an uncomfortable moan.

Now he circled around behind her, her head oscillating to follow, watching him.

Was he angry? Frustrated? She didn't think so, because he still bristled with dominant energy. Moving slow, his eyes stayed steady and confident on hers.

It chilled her to think she'd disappointed him—she didn't want that. She just didn't want to hurt Josh.

Devlin sat on the loveseat behind her, his legs open wide, and before she could turn right around to face him, he leaned forward and scooped a hand around her bare front, fingers sliding across her navel. He tugged her backward, and she stumbled against him, falling heavily to sit in his lap.

Instead of being angry, whipping around and scolding him, somehow falling back and being embraced against his strong body felt good. Her back was to his chest, and they both looked across the suite, sunlight coming in, the light flooding, nothing in the apartment was hidden.

She looked down at her naked body. Teeny bra only, bare stomach, garter belt straps to stockings, no panties, just the fuzzy patch that protected her sex. On either side of her thighs were Devlin's outstretched legs. Long and muscular, clad in expensive wool fabric . . . she began to writhe against him, feeling the generous shape of his huge package against the small of her back. The hand he'd tugged her with still lay flat on her stomach, but the other one now came around on the other side, fingers going right underneath the small triangles of her bra, forcing it outward, his fingers squeezing on her bare nipple and getting her to cry out. It'd all happened so fast—standing one moment, feeling bolstered with thoughts of courageous fidelity. The next second, she's sitting in his lap, feeling his cock on her back, eyes rolling in their sockets as he did amazing things to her nipple with a finger and thumb.

The hand over her navel slipped down between her legs, two fingers pushing up inside her swiftly with a slick sound. She was so wet.

“He said that's all you want. You want to come? That's all this is? Your boss using his hand to get you off, make you squirt all over your feet?”

She gasped and cried, rolling her back against his hard body.

“Josh make you come like that? Josh make you squirt?”

“Nuh-no . . .”

“No, he doesn't. You want to come, it's me you need,” he growled, fingers stabbing, the heel of his hand mushing hard on her clit better than she could ever do herself. He'd got her whole body quaking. Her hands clawed his strong thighs.

But she protested still: “Josh makes me come . . .”

“Not the way you want it . . .”

“No,” she admitted in a loud mournful cry. Giving up more ground. “Make me . . . make me come—please, make me come,” she sobbed, breath hitching in, her stomach rolling out then sucking in. And her eyes

appreciated the beauty of her own body despite this dark and terrible display. The black of her bra, the straps of garter, the smoke of her stockings on her long, toned legs . . . her own body aroused her.

“You can hate me,” he said, “so kiss me like you hate me.”

“I won’t kiss you,” she hissed, humping her pussy against his hand, bewildered how a man could know how to pleasure her so well just using his fingers.

“Fuck, you’re so hot,” he growled, big hand roughly grabbing at her small breast, her bra cup just a black triangle over his knuckles. “You’re even deceiving yourself . . .”

“I know,” she cried, closing her eyes, then squinting because she still liked the view of her body this way, didn’t want to miss it, loved to mate the feeling of pleasure between her legs and the ripe discomfort of his rough play on her nipples with the sight of her raw sexuality—the way his hands moved on her, the way her body writhed in response. “But I want to come . . .”

“I want to watch you come—show me . . .”

She moaned as an answer, shifting to the side, bracing her body against the hand that held her breast, opening her legs wider for him, wanting absolutely that: to be manipulated into one of those orgasms he provided. Then his hips were pumping his cock against her ass and back; she rode up and down on the swell of his pulsing. He bit her bare shoulder, squeezed her nipple, hooked the two fingers deeper inside her, their tips rolling and stretching out the bunched shapes of her forward wall. Feeling her interior being smoothed out was like a garden hose spritzing away chalk on the sidewalk. Chalk she’d used to draw wards and symbols to protect herself from the devil.

Just do it. One time. One time, and he’s already been inside you. You were fine with that. Just do it one time. It’s practically done. You know what it feels like. You know good it feels . . .

His growling voice very near her ear: “Put your hands behind your back . . .”

And she complied, folding both her arms at the small of her back, her wrists scoring over Devlin’s hard stomach.

“Grip my belt and hold on tight.”

“Yeah,” she gasped, a sudden high thrill between her legs, a bright feeling of pleasure from her pussy, Devlin’s fingers squirming and plunging, and knowing now he was going to bring her the release she craved. Her hands closed on the line of his belt; thin hard leather she gripped tight, her knuckles burning against the cotton over his abs.

“Kimmy just wants to come . . .”

“Yeah,” she said.

“You don’t want to get fucked at all . . .”

“I do,” she said, humping, chasing down the orgasm.

“I know you do, I know I’m going to fuck you. You want me to make you do it. I’ll fucking make you . . .”

“Yeah . . .”

“Yeah? Tie you down, fuck this tight little snatch like it’s never been fucked before—fuck it hard and deep till you’re crying my name . . .”

“Oh God . . .”

His teeth clamped on her earring, tugging on the gold stud Josh’d bought her on their fifth anniversary, pulling, releasing, then growling: “Then you can blame me . . .”

“Yes . . .”

“Yeah, you can blame me, it’s all my fault, nothing to do with skinny Kimmy Chang . . .”

“I don’t want it,” she grunted, tugging hard on his belt, wishing his cock was out so she could grab that instead.

“You want it so bad, you liar, listen to your pussy . . .” And her pussy obeyed his hand, producing the sounds of her lubrication; his fingers sluicing through her folds then plunging, making slick suction.

She closed her thighs on his hand, but that did nothing to stop Devlin from probing and teasing and touching her in amazing ways.

“Open your slut legs,” he said, “don’t hide it, open those legs and be honest . . .” His hand swirled, his knuckles pressing the insides of her thighs, his fingers still inside her. Slowly, her legs levered open again.

“Wider, Kimmy, show the room how wet I make you . . .”

Fingers squeezed her nipple hard, and she cried out. Then she hissed in air, said, “Kimmy Waters—not Chang . . .”

“Your business card says Kimmy Chang. Who’s got her legs open for me, Kimmy Chang or Josh’s wife?”

“Don’t . . .”

“Kimmy Waters has her legs open, about to come hard, and then I’m going to—”

“No—”

“And then I’m gonna put you on that bed and fuck you right . . .”

“Just make me come . . .”

“I can’t wait till my balls squash on your pussy, I can’t wait to see your face when you feel my cock in your stomach . . .”

“Oh God, no . . .”

“You want it so bad, you liar . . .”

“Oh, I’m gonna, it’s-ss . . .” Her body melted to his, and she hiked a leg over Devlin’s thigh, opening herself wide for him. His fingers fucked her deeper and harder and now she ululated sounds of impending release, her high voice almost unrecognizable singing to the luxury suite how she’d never felt such intense sexual pleasure in her whole life. Through her tear-squinted vision she could see the foot bobbing on the end of the long leg she’d hooked over Devlin’s powerful thigh. The garter, the stocking, the black patent Louboutin stiletto with a scalloped trim, her foot pointed, looking sexy and powerful—but despite her sexual power she was subjugated by the equivalent in masculine form; she the epitome of sexual desire for a man like her Josh, yet powerless under a man like Devlin Stone. And it was with that weird thought focused in her forward mind, like a beam from a flashlight, that she came hard—came hard the way Devlin could make her do. At first she thought it wasn’t going to happen. The orgasm began not with a clap but a slow bleed. Like water coming up from the soil and making the ground soggy instead of a lightning strike, and there was a moment—brief—that she thought that would be all her orgasm was. Then Devlin’s digital ministrations changed gear and in the midst of her lapping orgasm his fingers played through her sex, squeezing on the bulb of her sexual desire, biting her ear again, getting her stomach sucking in tight. Then it happened. The skies opened up, and the soggy ground was deluged by wet from above. The orgasm he delivered coming at her from all fronts. His fingers dove in, withdrew, cupped and squeezed; his teeth clamped along her earlobe; one of her nipples painfully squeezed in his pinching grip. And it happened while she watched. Fingers working into her like plunging a clogged toilet, Devlin cleared her blockage and a sizzling tickle laced through her brain and her sensitive commissure. She sprinkled clear liquid pleasure in a twinkling patter that arced high between her thighs and twinkled in the bright, orangey sunlight. The sight of her release gripped Devlin too, and he growled with her lobe in his mouth, his breath snorting in her ear. The sounds she made grew louder, and she threw herself at the pleasure with abandon; let it rip her wide. While she babbled wildly, the squirting continued, wetting the insides of her thighs, over her stockings,

onto his pants. Devlin loved it. Plunged her harder. There was the patter of her wet on his shoes.

“Oh god, oh god,” she cried, and still Devlin drew more from her till she went dim and dull. Devlin growled in her ear what a good slut she was, and if she thought the pleasure was over she was wrong—his hooked fingers lifted her higher by her pussy, her ass on his belt now, her arms grinding into his chest while her legs splayed out to the sides, bent, vulgar, her wet getting on her new shoes. Her fingers clawed his hard chest, her stomach tightened to a knot, and her voice grew thin, her cries of ecstasy breaking like thread as her oxygen depleted.

Devlin sat forward, holding her waist while she was still seized in orgasm, setting her down on the floor on her hands and knees, her forehead touching the floor. On her palms she could feel the wet she’d squirted onto the carpet and it made her think of black-lights and hotel rooms, everyone thinking it was all semen, but what if men were doing this to women in all these rooms, getting them to ejaculate whatever it was they had all over the place and no one was considering that? Pleasure still warbled through her, getting her breath light and fluttery, a ticklish feeling underneath the hard cramping layer of her stomach muscles.

Devlin rose from the sofa, stood behind her for a moment and she wondered what she looked like to him wearing what she was wearing, on all fours on the floor. He stepped around her, and her orgasm still buzzed—she was certain if he just touched her pussy right now she would come all over again.

Ignition

His shoes appeared in her field of vision as she raised her head off the floor. Shining black brogues on either side of her spread-out hands. It was a startling sight: Her wedding ring and diamond. The shoes of another man.

Devlin stooped, his hands on her back, feeling warm and strong, palms smoothing upward then unhooking her bra. She felt the straps loosen; the cups fall forward. His hands swept her skin again, now coming up to either side of her neck, guiding her upright, getting her on her knees and looking up at him. For the moment, her strength was depleted, she couldn't even raise up, had to sit back on her heels. Devlin looked down on her with a satisfied expression. But one also showing that this was only beginning. He studied her face, admired it, and she liked the feeling of him appreciating what he saw. He thumbed her cheek, let go of her neck, his hands then coming together above his belt. He undid his fly, reached in the open gap, then hauled out his massive manhood. Testicles and all coming out, thumb tugging down on the fly to give his ample meat some room, letting it go so it hung before her. Huge and almost hard, but hanging heavy before her eyes; two big testicles with the scrotum skin stretched tight, gleaming large and red-brown, pushed out on either side of his wide cock. The whole sight garish—his unnatural cock, swollen, crooked, wrinkled skin and veins, bulging (threatening) cock head, all juxtaposed against the fine black wool of his expensive suit.

With no hesitation, she rose on her knee points, put her hands on his thighs, gripped the fabric, pinching thumb and finger to pull herself straighter, kneeling before her boss's manhood in worship. Then she put both hands on his hot gummy cock and guided the head into her mouth.

Two hands gently stroking his shaft, she sucked the large bulbous end, eyes turned up to Devlin. His hands touched her face again, and he began to untie her bun. She'd worn sticks in it today, and he tossed them somewhere behind her, not hitting the rug, a wooden clicking clatter on the hardwood floor. Her hair hung around her neck and shoulders now, and her spit made her mouth glide on his enormous size.

Now he was undoing his tie, still watching her, only a small glimpse of pleasure in his eyes he would allow her to see. But she knew she was doing a good job for him. Knew how to please him. He grew harder, fatter. She loved the feel of him in her hands.

But what now? Get him to come in your mouth again?

She knew she would do more . . .

He snapped the tie with one hand, the fabric zipping through the underside of his shirt collar. Then, while she still sucked his cock, he wove the silky fabric in figure-eights around her wrists, tying them and then knotting them in place, her grip still on his long, thick cock.

Devlin wasn't interested in finishing in her mouth anyway, dropping down to a knee and cupping her cheeks, her hands lashed together by his expensive tie in the attitude of prayer between his forearms. She looked in his striking eyes, waiting to discover what he would do. He thumbed the corners of her mouth, like he wanted her to smile. "You don't want to kiss me?"

Eyes closed, she waited. Then his lips pressed hers. Dispassionate and cold, her face was a mask. Devlin took from her the most minimal of kisses, making his point rather than looking for passion. He pulled back, and she opened her eyes again.

"I know how you want it," he said.

She licked her lips, seeking to clean them but not wanting to taste his mouth on hers.

He said, “I’ll give you what you want.”

“What do I want?”

He smiled then, his hand stroking to the back of her neck, then gripping a handful of her hair at the back of her head. Not forceful, not painful, but firm. He shifted, guiding her to turn around so that they both faced the sofa again.

He eased her downward so that she was on all fours once more, two hands lashed together. The sofa was supported by legs at the four corners, and one more front and center. Devlin lifted the couch, pulled it forward a few inches, then set that middle point down between her forearms, trapping her hands. “I know how you want it. And that’s how I’m going to give it to you. Like an animal,” he said, getting close to her ear, his hand teasing the nape of her neck, his nails running down the center of her back, her small hanging breasts going tight and hard, nipples feeling like they might burst.

He continued: “I like it. That’s the way you want it and I like it. We’ll rut like animals. I’ll get what I want, get my dick inside you, and you’ll get what you want . . .”

She gave no response, staring at the floor, her hands trapped by the couch’s leg, her breaths coming quick and heavy, knowing they would fuck now—knowing Devlin meant to mount her from behind.

“You can bite the sofa,” he said, squeezing the front face cushion, squashing it. “Here,” he said, guiding her face to it. “Bite down on the couch and you can think of Josh while I fuck you from behind.”

She didn’t comply. Didn’t put her teeth on the sofa seat. Laid her cheek on it instead, her neck cranked awkwardly, face upright, the weight of her torso on her elbows, her hands tied around the front post of the sofa support. Devlin got behind her, but before putting his dick in her, out of nowhere a sudden crazy snap of flesh against her ass. He had spanked her once. Hard. Completely unexpected. And she’d never been struck on her bottom, ever in her life. That clap of his hand against her bare right ass cheek jolted her, set through her body a dynamic tension that caught her off guard. Her core

tightened, her pelvic floor tightened, her stomach went to a steel cable. And then she came. And while she moaned a sound of shocked glory, she felt the head of his cock pushing into her body. She hissed, drew in air, tightened her knees together, feet folding out sideways and curling inward, the expensive shoes she bought this afternoon slipping off her heels. And the feel of that plump cock head shape pushing into the forward pouch of her opening, filling it, set off another orgasm that had her crying and flopping a line of saliva onto the sofa seat. Now she did clamp her teeth on its fabric, holding it between the line of her pressed-down teeth to anchor her head so she wouldn't slip away as he pushed inside her body.

He'd been in her before. She knew what to expect. And he knew how big he was and how tight she was. Didn't ram it home like some perverted asshole. Sunk himself slowly like a torpedoed submarine landing nose first into a silty ocean floor. Centimeter by slow centimeter, he invaded her body, took control of her. Every sense she had shut off, leaving her focus on an electric webwork of sparkling light in the top of her skull being tuned by the feel of Devlin's huge cock sliding into her vagina without a condom.

It was degrading. On all fours, and Devlin, still wearing his suit with his cock and balls pulled out, squatted over top of her, feet on either side of her waist, her ass turned up. His hips pile-driving that huge cock into her, almost north to south. He was so deep—and he wasn't even giving her all he had. Only about half. It was outrageous that she already knew what half his dick felt like. And as the pain rose, starting at the points of her elbows and knees and working through her bones and joints like a toothache, the sizzle where his hand had struck her ass joining in, plus her pure unadulterated badness—her in lingerie with no panties, husband at home playing video games with his friends—she came again. Had already lost count. Was it three, four? They were rolling through her. Her teeth slipped off the couch, and she cried out.

“Like this? This is how you want it? Bite that couch, Kimmy, clamp it tight while I fuck you like this . . .”

And he continued driving that thing in and out like a piston. Spreading her so wide, but not deep yet. She wanted him deep. And she fucking hated it,

but she wanted to be face-to-face, too.

Her stomach muscles heaved in and out, so close to the edge of yet another orgasm, another one circling the rim ready to roll down in her hole. Her hands strained, her elbows came to her ribs, the tightness of his tie yanking on her wrists. And she didn't protest, instead letting out a creaky groan with each of his thrusts. Spurring him on, her sounds letting him know that no matter how much she said she didn't want this, her body was loving every inch of it.

He fucked her like that for minutes, each second she thought she would stop him finally. Tell him to pull out. But it didn't happen. Instead, she came again. Kicking her feet on the floor, one of her high-heeled shoes flicking free somewhere behind her.

After that orgasm, he palmed her back, ran circles along the base of her spine up between her shoulder blades. She purred for him, helpless to the sound. He withdrew his cock, beat it on her ass cheeks, grabbed her by the back of the neck with one hand, lifted the couch with his other. Helped her to stand, and she fell against the front face of the sofa. Her elbows scratched on the fabric, and Devlin took her by her waist, one hand slipped around her front, and he lifted her right off the sofa, carried her in his arms around behind it and lay her on the bed. Her wrists were still tied, and she writhed higher toward the pillows, both her high heels gone now, just stockings and garter, no bra. Looking down her body, she liked what she saw.

At the foot of the bed, she liked what she saw even better: Devlin with that massive cock hanging out of his fly. The first half of it shone with her insides. He was unbuttoning his shirt. She wanted him on top of her. Her heels stroked up the bedding, her knees raising. He chunked off his jacket and shirt together, pinky orange sunlight painting beautiful edges on all his gorgeous muscle. He had a narrow waist, abs, a broad chest that looked hard as steel. Shoulder muscles, flexing biceps with veins. And hair that ran from his chest down his stomach muscles behind his belt. He said, "Look how wet that pussy is."

She moaned at his lewd words—but loved them—raising her bound hands up above her head and into the pillows. Practically gyrating her hips, her

body betraying her again and letting Devlin know how bad she wanted that cock back inside her. He undid the belt buckle, snapped open the button of his pants but didn't remove them, instead climbing up the bed on his hands and knees, coming at her like a predator. He bit the inside of her thigh, and she closed her legs around his head. And then he was up, getting over top of her, her legs loosely circling his rump. His cock lay heavy on her belly, and now he hooked his thumb into the hoop of his tie that held her hands together, hoisting her arms up to hook them on a curled edge of the elaborate iron bed frame. She could smell his musk, smelled his soap, his sex. He was hot for her. He was in control, but she had worked him into a sexual fever. His cock burned on her sensitive stomach skin. She hooked legs tighter around him, his neck by her cheek. He fastened her bound hands to the headboard; she felt the weight of her arms sag against the restraint. He looked in her eyes, and she couldn't help it: she darted her chin up, took his mouth with a kiss. It surprised her more than it surprised him. He gripped her neck, thumbed her earlobe, kissed her, sucked on her mouth—but she still would not give him her tongue. She pulled her kiss away, turned and showed him her cheek. But knew he was smiling.

Then his hips were drawn back, the heat of that cock on her belly moving low, rustling through her pubic hair, that massive flanged helmet nestling in her core then pushing up inside her.

Soft groans of complaint escaped as his huge size pushed further into her body. The angle was different from when she was on her elbows and knees, not intensely uncomfortable, but he was so big the new angle felt like a whole different intrusion. “Slow,” she warned him. “God, slow—you are so big . . .”

His hands went up her ribs, and over her armpits, squeezed her elbows. He pushed deeper. She tightened her legs on him, then gasped, “My stockings . . .”

He withdrew, pushed in again.

“I want my stockings off,” she said.

He went up on his arms, knees out wide like an outrigger, cock inside her, pants unbuttoned, balls hanging over the edge of his undone fly. And now she wished she wasn't bound to the headboard. Thought how amazing it would be to put her hands all over his incredible body. Let him take her missionary, her legs around him, her hands stroking his back, her tongue in his mouth . . .

Devlin gripped both her ankles, raised her legs so that they lay on his chest and shoulders. His eyes were on hers as he slowly unfastened the four points of her stocking's garters. The straps fell around her waist, and then, taking his time, he began to unroll her stockings, and slipped them off her pointed feet.

Then he was over her again, his arms large and powerful, and she ached to put her hands on them, to run her nails down their hard rounded shapes. She writhed, her motion pushing his cock inside her, making it slip sideways and up and down. He pushed a little deeper, and she let him know she liked it. "So big . . ."

He did it again, thrumming his hips forward, feeding her a little more.

"Oh God, oh it feels . . ."

The stretch was incredible. The fullness magnificent.

This was more than what she'd taken before. In the front seat of his Mercedes, she'd sat on him and took him under her control. Not sex. Just a test. Because she'd told him that he was too large to accommodate. They couldn't get it in her at Tiffany's. But here he was proving she could definitely take him. She was lubricated and engorged, her canal loosened and lengthened, warmed up and ready to take him deep. "Deeper," she whispered.

Their eyes connected while he pushed deeper inside her body—more inches of cock than she'd ever had in her life. Her eyes widened as she was touched in the newest places—erogenous zones deep in her core that had never felt a man. The swollen shape of his cock head spread her out somewhere behind her navel and she drew in a deep breath.

He said, “You like it deep?”

She nodded, bit her lip, avoided his eyes a moment, hating how bad she was, but loving the feel of his size inside her body. She tightened her legs around his ass and loved the scratch of his tailored pants against her bare calves. “I like it deep,” she told him.

“You’ve got the tightest little snatch—you’ve never had a man inside you . . .”

“I ha-have . . .”

“Double-A.”

“Don’t call him that.”

“You only ever been fucked with his little battery, huh?” For emphasis, he flexed his cock, and the swelling fullness rolled her eyes up with pleasure.

She moaned and complained at his taunting, turning her face away and closing her eyes.

“You love a big dick.”

“No . . .”

“You do—I can feel how you love it, see it on your face . . .”

She gasped, hid her face—and a weird thing happened: she smiled. Then hid her smile. Devlin caught it, saying, “Look how much you love it—look at me and tell me you’ve had it deep before.”

“Don’t do that to me.”

“Look at me.”

She bit her lip, and slowly her head moved, coming face to face with his sneering devil mask. But he was so incredibly handsome, even like this, bent over her, face looming close . . . The angles of his face were

masculine, his eyes piercing but bright and lit like jewels in the setting sunlight. Caught in his gaze now, she studied and appreciated the physical beauty of the terrible man who had her pinned, his cock inside her body, her hands tied.

She confessed: “I’ve never had it deep.”

“Only Josh’s little plug?”

“Don’t do this.”

“Tell me this beautiful body’s been with more men than with just Josh.”

“I don’t want to talk like this.”

“Defend him.”

“Josh?”

“Tell me you like his little dick.”

She chuckled and the act of her stomach bouncing got his cock sliding in her guts, sending a wild tickle through her belly and spine. She gasped, then tried to hide it, saying, “Why do you want to be mean to him?”

“I don’t. I don’t care about him—it drives me wild to think I might be your first real man.”

“He’s a real man.”

“You’ve only ever been with him?”

“Kind of . . .”

Now he made a low sound in his chest, lifted off her body and looked down on her. Raised up higher, cock still deep, his stomach stretched and showing off his muscle, he studied her, still humming low, appreciative, eyes roaming, then his hands caressing her inner thighs, knees, hips, her ribs. “Josh can’t even know how fucking lucky he is.”

“Why?”

“Because you are perfection. Fucking perfection, Kimmy. Beautiful, smart, sexy.” He thrust his hands out, flat on the mattress on either side of her armpits, rolled his spine, his hips pressing hers, that huge cock claiming virgin territory, making her whine a high thin sound.

Devlin said, “He must wake up every day shocked to find you still in bed with him . . .”

Now his hips rolled against her in steady waves, his cock claiming every inch of her interior, the flanged head of his cock pulling and tugging on her tightest depths, plunging her juices into whorls of pleasure around the eye of her cervix. Her whining continued, and she was helpless to the sounds coming from her throat and lips while the deepest, wildest sexual pleasure was conjured from her core. Her head went back on the pillow and her natural instinct was to arch her back and thrust out her tummy—stretching her canal, letting him fuck her deep without hurting her, the head of his cock probably rolling over or under her cervix, poking that plump cock head into the folds of her fornix. The pleasure was insane. Josh always claimed knowledge of her G-spot, but this was double the pleasure of when he actually stroked it. This was deeper than Josh could ever go; the pleasure bigger. And Devlin teased at the spot with the head of his cock like he knew the spot was there and knew what it would do to her.

“What are you doing to me?” Her voice was a desperate, breathy cry. He was doing something to her on purpose. She knew it now. Like, not only did he have a huge cock, he also knew how to use it.

“You ever come from a deep fucking?”

“No . . . oh my God, what are you . . .?”

“Oh fuck you’re tight, Kimmy, thank god you’re with Double-A—I’ve never had it tighter, you’re like a virgin . . .”

“Don’t stop, don’t stop . . .” she demanded, eyes shut tight now, her hips swiveling against the steady pulses of Devlin’s hips, his cock buried to the

hilt in her body, his balls mashed in her ass cheeks.

The restraints bit at her wrists. Her arms tightened, body pulled taut like an overloaded clothesline; her fingers clawed at the silk of Devlin's binding, looking to get a grip on something. She gripped the fabric, locked her ankles behind his thighs and squeezed her body against him. It drove him even deeper. Just millimeters, but sparkling orbs of pleasure danced behind her eyes. She let out a warbled cry, and Devlin never stopped pulsing his hips. The tip of his cock relentlessly strobed over a tiny pocket deep in her interior that felt as wild and tingling as her clitoris. Her heels dug into the back muscles of his thighs. His legs were like iron. And now she wished she wasn't restrained again, wanted her hands to pound on his muscle, to feel the strength in his arms under her palms and fingers. To caress him, too, to touch his neck and his face while he did this to her. But instead she gripped tight the fabric in her sweaty palms, using it to pull her body in a long line, her stomach sucked in, ribs pressed out, her back arched. And still, that fat cock head touching, touching, and touching this deep button of sexual insanity . . .

And finally it was too much. Her hands squeezed on the tie so tight her arms shook, then the shaking traveling into her shoulders, trembling through her torso, tensing the muscles of her ribs and stomach; her nipples ached and tightened further. She twisted—the act of twisting making the pleasure trigger off into an electric stratosphere. She cried out. Cried out profanity, holys and oh gods and even Devlin's name. He pulsed and pulsed, still touching that spot, and just as the skies had opened up and the release of rain fell to the earth, his deep steady fucking right through her orgasm conjured thunderhead after thunderhead, three orgasms in a row—each one breathtaking. Each one falling like a tsunami wave on top of its predecessor. She flooded between her legs. Could feel that squirting release again. That wet and slippery tickle that zipped down from below her belly button to the split in her folds just above her clitoris. Despite his size, his intrusion went to liquid. She bit her own bicep to stop from shrieking.

Deep Secrets

What worried him the most was what he looked like from behind. Like if a third party was watching him. But most worriedly: what if that third-party was Kimmy or Devlin? Coming up from behind him, what would his behavior look like? Because it would be bad enough to be discovered in the lobby of the Royal York, but it would be worse if he was obviously poking around and looking like he was spying. It led to him constantly looking over his shoulders. That was the biggest fear. Them sneaking up on him, maybe Kimmy grabbing his arm and quietly hissing, “Josh, what the hell are you doing here?”

And he’d be caught. What would you have to say to that?

But he wasn’t going to wait outside on the street any longer. Nothing would come of that. And he didn’t drive all the way into the city to eat a hot dog. So despite the rapid thrumming of his heartbeat, he’d entered the lobby of the Royal York. No idea where the lounge or bar that they were supposed to meet at was, but the place had enough foot traffic that he could lose himself in the crowd. He did two circuits of the lobby, looking around like he was lost, then on his second lap checking his watch and looking out windows like he was pretending someone was supposed to meet him and they were late. By the second lap, he had his bearings, and could see where the lounge was. Problem was, it was open. Not just one door, but multiple points of exit and entry. So now he played the game of waiting. Extending his act: checking his watch and reading his phone now. Wandering around, face down to his phone’s screen, and occasionally looking up to see if his party had arrived yet. But no party was coming. And the only thing he looked at on his phone screen was the throbbing dot indicating the proximity of his

wife's phone. These things were inexact at close distance, but their dots practically overlapped.

He wandered now with hand in pocket, face turned to his phone but eyes dashing up to the left and to the right, trying to get angles of vision into the Royal York's lounge. Worried he would actually see them together. But fuck it. So what if you saw them sitting together, and it ruined your evening? Big deal. That is what was happening—Kimmy and Devlin were meeting after work. So grow up and accept it. Get your eyes on it, and yeah, it's going to hurt, and you might not sleep tonight, but . . .

But what?

You came all this way to see them sitting together? No.

He came all this way to prove he was right. To prove that Kimmy was up to no good. Not Kimmy. Devlin. But Devlin had seduced his wife into bad behavior . . .

It took ten minutes, but he checked all the angles of the entrances to the Clockwork lounge. Lots of well-dressed people in suits sitting and having cocktails. Business meetings, friendly meetings. Trysts, too, probably. Men and women together, meeting after work, cheating on their spouses.

Why had his imagination taken this sour turn in the last few months? Devlin putting it in his head that Josh wanted Kimmy to have sex with Devlin. That wasn't true. But then again, was that phantom Devlin even real?

Now he was standing at one of Clockwork's entrances (so sure Kimmy and Devlin weren't there he didn't mind being seen) acting like someone interested in having a seat, but still ready to dart out of the room should he detect them in there. But nope. They weren't in there.

He backed out of the Clockwork into the Royal York's bright marble lobby, biting his lip, mind moving a thousand miles an hour.

Good news was he didn't get a glimpse of Kimmy and Devlin together. Bad news was: where the fuck were they?

Up in a hotel room. It was so fucking obvious. Right now Kimmy's with Devlin in a hotel room right above your head. Look at those two dots on the screen. That's her. Fifty, a hundred, maybe a hundred-fifty feet above your head right now in bed with another man.

It wasn't proof. But it was proof.

A sudden surge of sadness hit him. Heavy weight appearing out of nowhere laden across his weakening shoulders, trying to push his knees to the marble floor. His stomach turned over. That hot dog didn't like where it was. That hot dog found out his stomach wasn't a stable home. He burped and tasted orange. Mustard. Sauerkraut. Hot dog. He palmed his forehead like he had a fever. It really was true. Kimmy and Devlin were fucking.

"Jesus," he moaned, and could hear the sadness in his voice. There were way too many people walking around him to break down in tears.

Would he cry over this?

Damn right he would.

How could she fucking do this to him?

The most he allowed himself was a sniffle. A very wet sniffle followed by the wiping of his eyes. And his eyes were wet.

But wait. What if there's another lounge in the hotel? Maybe on the third floor there was a restaurant. Maybe they were in the restaurant. Or maybe those Chinese guys or wherever they were from—most likely Chinese—maybe they had a suite. Maybe they were all in the suite. It was possible, too . . .

One thing was for sure, he didn't want to be here anymore and regretted coming in the first place . . .



Devlin's tie-binding around her wrists had gone so tight her hands felt swollen. She was sure they were purple.

In the stupor of the craziest, most deeply provoked orgasm she'd ever felt in her life, he turned her powerless body face down. He claimed her from behind, her long weak legs splayed out in the sheets, his cock going in half its length, pounding, pounding . . . The pleasure was intense. Then he turned her over again, got her on her back. She looked up and saw the room had gone dimmer. The golden light had drained, and that glowing pastel color had stopped pulsing on the flat polished surfaces of the suite's amenities. It was dull and gray and blue. Out the window, the sky had gone to amaranth.

Devlin's body loomed above her, mostly a dark silhouette of masculine edges—his powerful shoulders and chest, the angle of his jaw. His hair hung around his brow. He pushed her knees to her shoulders, put himself inside her again and fucked her so slow her heart raced in anticipation of his length touching that deep part of her again. Her canal was shortened by the awkward position, and Devlin only teased her, never delivering the depth she wanted. She chortled breath. Words somehow escaped her. Her mind functioned fine, but her mouth was unable to make phrases. But what did she even want to say?

And then he turned her over another time. Got her on her knees with her breasts touching the pillows, hands still hooked on the headboard. He fucked her from behind and was still careful not to go too deep.

Now here she was being rolled onto her back again, binding tightening, her hands about to pop.

Devlin got over her again, his head cocked, eyes studying her. Gauging his affect. What would he see? A woman cheating on her husband. A woman he'd had to work incredibly hard to get in his bed. A woman he'd had to

offer a job even. Maybe. Had to give her the big bucks so he could get her in this hotel room. And she hadn't come here easy. Needing rules and requiring full disclosures, lots of preambles. Lots of protocol. No kissing. Don't talk about my husband. A lot of smart talk. A lot of tough talk. That night at the Dragon in Ajax, the way she laid it all out for him how she couldn't work for him and how he'd given her the song and dance how sex was separate from the job. All that, and yet here she was reduced to a lifeless tangle of limbs and tossed hair, teacup breasts heaving on her chest, stomach sucking in and out. Rendered useless. If she were to speak, she would babble senselessly right now. Her mouth hung open. He had literally fucked her into black oblivion. But wasn't this what she'd wanted—wasn't this what Amy had raved about?

The things Amy'd tried to tell her all those years ago she didn't even want to hear. She wasn't that kind of girl. Amy would tell her details, and she would laugh and roll away and put her hands over her ears. Didn't want to hear about her friend's sex life when they were supposed to be studying. But before her hands had clamped protection over her sensitive virgin eardrums, words had entered them. And there was storytelling in Amy's expression, too. Amy would marvel at how big Devlin's penis was. How good he was in bed. The things he'd done with her and to her . . . Though she protected herself from the dirtiest details, there was pervasive knowledge that whatever Devlin had done to Amy, Amy could not stop talking about it. She was obsessed with Devlin. Obsessed to the point Devlin had talked Amy into inviting a third person for some playtime. And Amy'd invited Kimmy. But Kimmy ran away.

Now at the age of twenty-eight—and married to a man she loved—she knew what Amy had been talking about. Knew what she'd missed. And Devlin wasn't a high school boy anymore. What he'd done to her tonight would be more than Amy had ever known. Because this was annihilation. Sex like she couldn't even imagine a person could have. Didn't know you could sweat so much. Didn't know every muscle in your body could ache so gorgeously. Didn't know her pussy could feel so fucking good. Didn't know a man could do the things that Devlin had done to her tonight.

“My . . . ha-hands . . .” Two simple words that took great effort to utter.

In the dark she could see a glint of light from his smile. He lowered his tongue to her chest, ran the tip over the corrugated ridges of her ribs to her collarbone, kissed her neck. His right hand swooped up her armpit, over her elbow. With his fingers curled around the binding of his tie, he unhooked her wrists from the headboard. She brought her elbows down, her arms fell useless in the pillows. But he gathered up her wrists and guided her elbows down to her sides. She hissed because it was sore. He was careful.

Her arms had gone cold, and there were pins and needles in her shoulders. He held her wrists and tried untying the knot of his tie. But their fucking and twisting had tightened the knot, and in the end he forced her hands downward on her wrists, unfolded one of the tie's loops then was able to work it free, tossing his ruined tie to the floor. He kissed her hands, and they were cold and numb. He lay them on his chest and the heat of his skin blazed on her palms.

She caressed his body, caressed the hardness of his chest, down the edges of his stomach muscles. But if her eyes weren't open, she probably couldn't sense what she touched. Her fingers were numb.

"You're fucking amazing," he said, and his low rumbling voice was loud in her ears. All she'd heard for—oh wow, how long had this been going on?—a long time was hissing and breathing, the wet sounds of her sex being impaled, the rustling of bedsheets, the groaning of the bed . . .

She opened her mouth but couldn't answer. He smiled, lowered his face again between her breasts, and she tucked her chin down to watch his mouth close on her nipple. It had bunched hard and tight, balled up on her chest like a cherry pit. His mouth was warm and wet, and her legs tried to writhe but barely moved. He kissed across to the other nipple, gave it the same warm, wet treatment. His hand stroked her arm, touched her neck. Then he was over her again, cock in his hand, aiming it at her opening. And though she'd been pummeled, and knew she would be sore, she wanted him again, tilting up her pelvis to meet his reentry. He pushed himself in, eyes on hers, going slow again.

"Deep," she said. He'd given it to her once, and it was incredible, then teased her until the sunlight bled from the sky. "I want it . . . deep."

“I know you do,” he said, his hand touching her cheek then up her brow, smoothing her hair from her face. His palm went over her skin, slick with her sweat. Her hair was a tangled mess. But he sweated too. Both of their bodies slippery where they touched. This was the sex women wrote about.

Her eyes went narrower the deeper he got. Her mouth fell open wider. He bit her lower lip, held it pinched between his teeth as he gave her every inch, and now she knew what to do with his huge meat, arching her back, pushing her tailbone down angling her hipbones forward. Get that cock head deep where she wanted it. When he touched her deepest folds, her eyes fluttered, and she tried to groan. Nothing came out but a long dry creak.

That hard fleshy club flexed inside her, all her space filled out and stretched, and she could feel every shape of him (knew it well because her hands had been all over it), and she could pinpoint the bulges of the veins, the flared rim of his swollen glans. His hips pulsed, the tip prodded, coaxing from her that slippery, lubricious, dark star that twinkled in the back of her mind. A constellation marker line pulsing directly from her deepest most gynecological point and connecting to the dark crypt of her dirtiest sexual desire hidden in the recesses of her thoughts.

His hand went up her ribs, his thumb over her nipple. Then down, along the inside of her thigh, pushing the knee outward, the outside of her thigh flat on the mattress. She was exposed to him and claimed fully. His other hand cradled the back of her neck as he bit her collar, her throat, and just below her ear. As the orgasm grew, his voice grumbled. “Are you going to get away with it this time, my bad Kimmy?”

She gasped a bright Oh sound; a spark going off in that dark part of her brain again. She was so bad.

His cock flexed. “You’re going to get away with it.”

“Yeah,” she gasped, hooking her right arm around his back, her nails digging into his hard muscle to prevent from slipping away. It felt incredible to hold him while he was inside her.

“You going to rub it in his face?”

“No!”

His hips pulsed, the tip probed, but Devlin still keeping this huge impending orgasm on a simmer. She humped her hips against his, wanting it triggered.

“You love being bad.”

“No, I don’t,” she said, her head thrashing left and right, her body squirming against his, wanting to be delivered to that ecstasy again.

“You’re going to come.”

“Make me . . . Please make me . . .”

“I’m going to come inside you.”

She let out another soft cry. Not an objection, but a harrowing sound that showed her admission of her own badness. She wanted him to come inside her. Her nails scratched on his muscle, and her stomach began to tremble—every bolt shaking loose, the orgasm building and building, rattling her bones.

“Going to come inside you so deep . . .”

“Ah, oh no . . .”

“You feel it right here?” he said, and she swore to God he flexed his cock head, that fat bulbous knot throbbing inside her, beating like a second heartbeat. “You feel that? . . .”

“Oh my God,” she cried, hooking out her left arm, both her arms around his strong body, nails clutched and holding on for dear life. “I’m going to . . . I’m going to come . . .”

“Yeah, you’re going to come,” he said, poking and prodding again, cock head throbbing.

“Oh my God . . . oh my God . . .”

“I’m going to come inside you so deep Josh will never find it, it’ll be our secret . . .”

It was an awful thrill to hear something so terrible and sexually devious.

“Deep, where Josh can never go,” he said.

“Oh fuck, I’m going to come . . .”

The orgasm was rushing to her shore—emanating from this aching coal of desire inches above her navel. Where Devlin’s cock was buried, where his urethra would expel the contents of his testicles. Her nails dragged low, her hands descending over the hard humps of his round ass. She dug in her nails, grabbed his ass and humped herself against his hips. “Come, I want to . . . ah, make me . . .”

He began to roll with her, and she with him, her clawed hands gripped on his perfect ass, his enormous cock impaled in her fully. Throbbing, pulsing, her orgasm rising to roller coaster heights, eyelashes fluttering.

“I’m going to come so deep inside you, Kimmy, and you’re going to go home like a dirty slut, keep my seed in your belly, sleep next to him with my sperm splashed on your womb . . .”

She wailed, “Oh god, no . . .”

“Tell me you want it, Kimmy, tell me you want to feel my come in your belly . . .”

“Come inside me, oh . . . come deep inside me . . .”

And with that, he stabbed into her, over and over, and she fucked him back just as hard, her sex-weakened body finding last reserves, burning the fumes of glycogen to help her pussy claim the orgasm she knew Devlin could give her.

When Devlin came she could feel it. Could feel his hot jets firing off in her core, could feel the bulging knot of that huge cock head throbbing with his ejaculations, shooting stream after stream into her deepest recess. And that was what triggered her into the most incredible simultaneous orgasm. Two lovers intertwined, imbedded, reaching their climax together. Her with a man she didn't even like, didn't even respect. One who did terrible things to her husband. But he was hot, and he was hung, and his touch did wild things to her body. Not her heart, but that dirty place. And the pleasure he kicked over in this moment was unbelievable. As she cried out his awful name, pinned under him, gored by him, his come filling her belly, she grimaced and snarled, hating the lust that overwhelmed her—but it was quashed, extinguished under the enormous torrential weight of her huge, screaming wet orgasm.

Wellness

First thing she noticed when her eyes opened was the color of the nighttime sky. Or the lack of color. All that purple had drained, leaving only blackness lit from below by orangey harbor-front lights. Night sky meant nighttime, meant it was late . . . A domino-collapsing series of thoughts that had her heart jumping, momentarily unsure of where she was, but knowing something was terribly wrong. Her mind pinpointed a deep dread: The knowledge she had done something terrible that had to be hidden from Josh. It was late. Very late . . .

She shot up, reality beginning to percolate: she was in bed with another man, in a hotel room, the Royal York, way downtown, more than an hour from home probably, and she better get going . . .

Her voice: “What time is it?”

Devlin’s voice from somewhere: “Hmm?”

“Oh shit,” she said, aware of an allover ache through her body. Though not a bad one, a stretched out feeling like she’d gone through a grueling yoga class. Naked, she slipped off the bed, putting her feet on the soft carpet runner, heaving off then and lurching to find her phone.

Once up though, a surprising reality swooned, waiting for her. Her legs were boneless. Useless. And as quickly as she’d stood at the side of the bed, she collapsed onto her hands and knees. Somewhere, Devlin chuckled. She groaned, put her hand between her thighs and cupped it over her beaten pussy. Her hamstrings were gone. Like she didn’t have any, and her ass muscles, too, nothing there, no muscle, just a bowl of Jell-O.

But she didn't hurt, at least not badly, and now for some reason she found her situation funny. She chuckled, raising upright, hand out and holding on to a bench at bedside, walking forward then on her knees, lunging to hook her hands on the arm of the nearest chair.

Devlin's low and calm voice from somewhere: "Somebody got fucked."

"Yeah," she gasped, chuckling still, but with a renewed sense of urgency asking: "What time is it?"

There was a pause as she knee-walked across the carpet now, between the sofa where he fingered her and the chair where she'd left her purse. Once she had hands hooked in her purse, she dragged it into her seated lap, and searched for her phone.

Devlin said, "A couple minutes after nine."

Sure enough, when she swiped awake her phone, she saw it was 9:05 in the evening.

"Crap," she muttered, put her cheek in her palm. She could tell by looking at the blackness of her phone no text had come in. Josh hadn't been pondering her whereabouts, and she didn't know if that was good or bad.

She looked back to the bed now, saw that Devlin had been laying next to her. He was naked, one long leg crossed over the other. The table lamp was on, and he held his phone on his stomach, flicking through with his thumbs, that bloated penis laying on his leg, deflated now, arousal satisfied—it had deposited its excitement deep in her belly.

"Oh my God, I gotta get home . . ."

"It's only nine," he said without looking up.

"It's late," she said, pushed her purse down to the floor, used the reduced strength of her arms to get herself sitting in the chair. She flicked open her phone, opened up a text message with Josh.

Kimmy: meeting done, on my way home right now

She sent it off, rested her elbows on her knees, and her cheeks in her palms. She wouldn't be home until after ten o'clock. The meeting she told Josh about was at six. What kind of business meeting takes three hours?

She breathed heavy a moment, feeling that regret weighing on her back. The awful thing she'd done.

Then it occurred to her to use Find My Phone, see where Josh was. A hopeful thought. Maybe he was out seeing a superhero movie with Steve or Meyer and wasn't even thinking about her. With the app open, she waited and waited, finally saw that his dot was in the vicinity of their apartment. He was at home. Nine o'clock, at home without his wife—was he fuming mad? Was he maybe playing video games and not thinking about her? . . . She looked at the message she'd just sent: no return text came. She said to the room, "I have to get in the shower."

Devlin was sitting up now, putting his phone down on the bedside table. He strode from bedside around the sofa, coming her way. She admired the way the light played on his muscular body, and that roguish look on his face. A twinkling meanness in his eye, but a mirthful slant to his mouth. And then she watched the way his big floppy penis bounced off from thigh to thigh. How could one man be so sexual? How could he have everything?

He came to her with hands out as she rested her phone across her naked thighs, then put her hands in his. His penis dangled before her eyes, and she couldn't look away. A thing so unlike how she knew a penis to be. So large and masculine and wondrous. Seeing it up close and flaccid sparked a strange hurt in her stomach, a twist of desire urging her to inspire hardness in it, bring the magnificent thing to life.

He said, "Relax, Kimmy. Take deep breaths."

"I'm fine, I just have to get home."

“It’s only nine o’clock.”

“Josh doesn’t know where I am . . .”

But he did. She’d told him she’d be at the Royal York. Thinking when she told him, there was no way she would ever end up in a hotel room with Devlin Stone—not after Josh expressed how Devlin had affected him when they were younger.

Now she frowned, a worrisome thought making its way through her. She’d just used Find My Phone to locate Josh. What if Josh had done the same to her in the past weeks? She’d never even considered it. But what would Josh have seen tonight? He would’ve seen that she’d been at the Royal York the whole time, just like she’d said she’d be. And yet that was terrible . . .

She let her hands slip from Devlin’s, grabbed her phone and dropped it in her purse. She said, “Would you help me up? I have to get in the shower.”

Devlin helped her to stand, and her inability to keep herself upright had her chuckling again. Devlin, too. But she was steadier now, wouldn’t fall again. He said, “You’re not having a shower.”

“I am. I stink.”

Devlin still held her hands, looking down on her. “Go home like that.”

“I can’t go home like this,” she said, shaking her head at the ridiculousness.

“Imagine if you could get away with it.” He let one of her hands go and moved aside for her to pass. He said, “You want me to walk you? Are you going to be okay?”

“I’m fine,” she chuckled, took a few tentative steps. She wasn’t woozy, not dizzy, she wasn’t going to fall—and the more steps she took, the more her legs remembered how to walk. Made it to the couch, holding onto it, she hobbled around, heading to the bathroom, bracing herself on the wall.

Behind her, Devlin said, “Don’t shower, Kimmy, and when you come out, come out with a robe.”

“Okay,” she agreed, but knowing she was going to shower, and not caring why he wanted her to wear a robe.

In the bathroom, she flicked on the lights and locked the door behind her.

There she was, Kimmy Chang in the mirror. And she didn’t hate what she saw, even though she knew what that woman was guilty of. One time. One time she cheated. One time to get the thing she’d missed, and to maybe get a taste of the kind of wild, dramatic life you saw in movies.

While she felt like she’d been hit by a truck, the woman in the mirror looked quite good. Naked except for a garter belt with dangling straps, hair a mess, but there was a gleam in her drowsy eyes. Her cheeks were rosy, enlivened. Sure, she looked a little sleepy, and her posture could be better, but she put her hands on the counter, and got closer to her reflection and looked in her eyes to see what a person could read there. She touched her face, looked at herself from side to side. There was nothing that would show. Nothing on her face that said she was a terrible cheating wife.

She levered on the shower, and it was glancing back to her reflection she saw the first evidence. Shit.

A handprint on her ass cheek. Not completely legible, but since she knew that Devlin had smacked her there, she could make out what looked like the blurry thumb and two fingers on her haunch. She checked the other side, then the insides of her thighs. No bruises. No marks.

While the shower got to a hotter temperature, she carefully lowered herself to sit on the toilet. Her ass cheeks hurt against the seat. She groaned, put her hand over her stomach, and as the anger of approaching urination came, a fiery sensation laced the yoke of her vagina. She jolted and hissed as she began to pee what felt like flaming turpentine. Her knees clapped together, and her urine sputtered in the toilet. She pressed a hand flat on her stomach and grimaced, trying to reduce the firehose release of her bladder to softer tinkling, tightening all her muscles to relieve the burden between her legs. It took a minute to evacuate her bladder, and in the end, she was left panting. Her upper lip went clammy, and her brow had sweated. She chuckled, leaving her forearms over knees. Devlin had destroyed her. She had just had

the absolute most stellar sexual experience of her life. Nothing like that had ever happened before. She'd never had orgasms like that, ever. One after the other. Multi-orgasmic, she'd read once. Though she had orgasms with Josh, it had never been chains of them like what had happened tonight. And when Devlin'd fucked her so deep, he'd touched something inside her—literally touched it, physically not spiritually—he'd found a sex button she didn't even know about. And that button sent off nuclear fireworks of ecstasy.

Now she sat looking across as steam began to billow against the glass walls of the luxury suite's shower. A certain thrill returned. A feeling of being somebody else. But that somebody else was already inside her. A facet of her personality, reflecting light from the darkness. And that angle on her psyche was connected deep with her sexuality. It wasn't devious. It felt more powerful than cunning. Because she liked how it felt. Liked to feel that connection from lust to badness to power. A triumvirate of sexual independence. What she'd done tonight emboldened her, and the deviousness was only to preserve the feelings of the man she loved. She was in Devlin Stone's suite at the Royal York. He was paying her an enormous sum of money to utilize those trained parts of her mind and intelligence for profit. She was part of an elite machine. And she liked everything about who she was.

Toilet flushed, she used the countertop to get herself standing, finding her sea legs now, able to walk across the tiled floor and shut down the shower. Stuck her head in, felt the warmth of the steam, and knew it was a much better idea to get in there to soak herself, to clean off the filth of what she'd done. But she didn't. Instead, she plucked from the hook on the back of the door a fresh white terrycloth robe, unfastened her garter belt, put on the robe and tied it at the waist. She checked her reflection, but didn't smile. Put a hand on her stomach, thinking how another man had injected his semen inside her, knees weakening at the thought of Josh smiling at her, not knowing another man's evidence swam deep in her guts. Then she shut off the light, returned to the lounge. She would shower before she left—the reality was impossible, and she would never go through with it. Tightening the robe's belt as she limped through the lounge, she groaned in complaint: "I think you mangled my urethra—"

They weren't alone.

Devlin sat on a padded chair in the corner, his suit on, no tie—but on the closer side of the bed, a young woman in her early twenties prepared items on the mattress. Long hair tied back in a bun, she wore latex gloves and a white smock with black pants. And while she made no note of what Kimmy'd just said, her hands mimed through unproductive motions and her face held the expression of someone trying to show no reaction—because she absolutely heard what Kimmy'd just said.

Her heart jumped and a whack of shame went across her front; she pivoted, moved to the bathroom door where she wouldn't be seen by the girl, and leaned on the wall. Heat blazed her cheeks and collar and the tips of her ears. “Oh my God,” she sighed into her hands, heart thudding in her chest. Then she gathered herself, tightened her robe, and re-emerged.

Devlin sat, legs open, phone face down on a thigh, smiling, obviously enjoying her embarrassment.

She said lightly, “What's going on?”

Devlin said, “Ellie's here for you,” nodding his chin to the young blond girl.

Ellie bowed and nodded her head, saying softly, “Pleased to meet you,” her blue latex hands coming together at her waist, squeaking fingers intertwining. The girl was beautiful, no makeup, but seemed timid. And her cheeks had gone red too. She wore a gold nameplate on her smock with her name on it.

“Here for what?”

Devlin rose, then sat on the far side of the bed, patting it like he wanted her to lay down. “Recharge your batteries. Get you on your feet again”

“Recharge my . . .?”

Ellie said, “It's a wellness protocol,” all smiles, blinking her sweet blue Bambi eyes.

At the foot of the bed there was an opened black neoprene sling, and inside the sling there were loops that cinched vials and needles. Next to the sling was a zippered-open briefcase with plastic packets of clear fluid, like IV bags.

Devlin patted the bed saying, “Lay down. You never had a hydration IV?”

“No,” she said cynically—because no one had hydration IVs. “An IV? For what?”

“Hydration,” he said, still patting for her to join him. She turned, scooped the robe under her naked butt and sat on the edge of the bed. Ellie stepped back to give her space. Devlin continued: “Put you back on your feet in no time. Send you home with a skip in your step.”

She doubted that. Skipping might take a few days. What she wanted to ask was if this was some sex thing. Was Ellie some kind of sex worker? But the girl, while pretty, looked the opposite of a sex worker: all innocence and sweetness and customer service, and a crisp uniform. Also a medical professionalism.

“This is for real?”

Devlin said, “Babe, lay back, put your head on the pillow,” and he rested his hand on her thigh, palm on the terry robe. It was a very familiar action and done in the presence of another party. This young girl now party to her infidelity.

And at that thought her eyes drifted low, looking where Ellie was looking. There was a gap high in the opening of her robe, showing off the naked interior of her thighs—but that’s not at what she looked. Devlin’s left hand rested on her thigh, her left hand on her other thigh. Ellie saw her wedding rings and also saw that Devlin had no wedding band. The girl wanted to check if her patients were married. And no, they weren’t. And yes, it was obvious. They’d been fucking. Shit, her stockings were on the floor, her high-heeled shoes, her bra; the sheets were mussed, Devlin was already dressed. And, oh God, that awful thing she’d said coming out of the bathroom thinking they were alone . . .

She inexplicably rested her hand over Devlin's hand. Devlin was obviously playing a game, pretending they were a couple for the girl's sake—even though it was obvious she was here for a tryst. She said to Devlin, "You're not having one . . . babe?" It was fun to show him she could play along, not get bowled by his bad behavior. He'd throttled her during sex, took control and dominated her, and now she had to scrape back respect.

"I've got to run," he said, squeezing her thigh, her hand riding on his flexing tendons.

"You do?" It took effort, but she hid the natural disappointment from her voice. What did it matter if he left?—she had to get home to Josh.

"Yeah, I've got—"

"I've got to get home, anyway," she said, matter-of-fact.

Devlin regarded her profile, and she looked his way, caught him admiring her, an honest look of satisfaction on his face.

She said, "What?"

No words as an answer. Instead he moved his face toward hers, his hand taking her chin. He gave her a slow and soft kiss, and she let him.

When it broke, she licked her lips, tightened the flaps of her robe across her thighs.

Devlin said, "Ellie—give her a B12 shot, too. Bring her back to life. She's depleted."

She rolled her eyes, hoping Ellie saw her resilience, and watched as Devlin backed off the bed and straightened his suit. Both women watched him, and holy hell was he hot. A pride swelled her, another woman witnessing the kind of man who was interested in her, who had her in his bed—Ellie probably thinking wow, who was this Asian tiger, and how can I be her?

Devlin adjusted his cuffs at the sleeve hem of his suit jacket, saying, "Kimmy, how we doing with the guys from Xiu Wu Chemical?"

“I talked to them this morning, they sent the paperwork, I read it over. It looks straightforward.”

“What about those Czechs?”

“Which ones?”

“The ones making claims against us.”

“Oh. They’re Czech but they’re Canadian—and they’re out of their minds. I filed against them. Vexatious lawsuits. I’ll diminish them, and if they ever get us in court, they’ll embarrass themselves.”

Devlin made a prideful grumbling sound that thrilled her unexpectedly. “You drive me crazy, Kimmy.” Then to Ellie: “You believe this woman?” Ellie smiled wide but unknowing, trying to be polite, stepping back as Devlin came around her side of the bed.

It was fun, the two of them engaging in some post-coital banter that showed she wasn’t a prostitute or something, some bimbo. Both of them putting on a bit of theater for this young woman who would probably be texting her friends the minute she packed up her gear and exited the suite. Ellie’d tell her friends about the sexy cheating couple in the luxury suite, tell them how hot the businessman was in his suit . . . and what would she say of the lawyer woman in his bed?—would she be described as pretty or would she be castigated for cheating on her husband? She didn’t care, but for some reason the idea of being the subject of exciting gossip was exhilarating and she’d love to overhear the conversation. Hoped Ellie’d tell her friends the Asian woman had good taste in men and shoes.

Devlin dipped low at bedside, put a hand on her waist as he got near. He said, “And you’re going to keep our secret?”

“Secret?”

His hand moved from her waist to rest below the knot on her robe, just below her navel. The deep wet secret. The ejaculation he’d hidden in her body where Josh wouldn’t find it. A dirty taunt because her husband’s penis

wasn't long enough to find where her lover reached. It was juvenile and malicious, but something about the pretend cruelty was arousing and it didn't displease her though it really should. In fact, she could feel a blush strike up on her cheeks, and she chuckled. "No way," she said.

"You didn't shower."

"No."

Devlin chuckled now, looking in her eyes. He said, "You drive me fucking wild." Then to Ellie, "Excuse my language."

She didn't register Ellie's reaction because her eyes still engaged Devlin's eyes and now his lips moved toward hers for a kiss. And though she'd put up a rule about not kissing him (because she didn't really like Devlin), she'd already kissed him while they fucked, and she wouldn't embarrass him needlessly in front of Ellie, not while they were all getting along so well and the drama had played out nicely, so she accepted his lips with her own. His hand stroked her stomach to her waist, and their kiss lingered. She wouldn't give him her tongue, but she held their mouths locked, and touched his neck.

Then he let her go, stood, readjusted his jacket. He said, "Maybe I'll see you at the office tomorrow."

"You in Kingston or Toronto?"

"Don't know yet. If I'm here, we'll do lunch."

"Sounds good."

"Ellie," he said to the patient nurse, "Take care of my girl. She's the best lawyer I know."

"Yes, sir," Ellie said, nervously wringing her hands and still smiling.

Then before turning to leave, he said, "Say hi to Josh for me," smirking.

“Bye, Devlin,” she said and watched him walk out through the lounge, then heard the suite’s door open and close.

Ellie was right to business: “So the Hydration IV is packed with electrolytes and antioxidants,” unpacking from her case expandable poles that she figured would be the stand that would hold up the IV bag, “and it’s loaded with all the daily mineral levels you need for—”

She interrupted: “How long does it take?”

Ellie stopped, paused with two poles, ready to insert one into the other. “Oh, it won’t be long.”

All business now too, she said, “Good, I need to get home to my husband.”

Brick Walls

Ten after eleven, she fucking gets home.

There was the sound of her high-heeled shoes on the tiles of the foyer, the banging of her keys. Then a space of silence. Probably looking around the apartment and wondering where he was. Well, he was in bed. Yeah, it was only a bit after 11 P.M., but the day had drained him. Plus, there was no way he wanted to have the conversation he wanted to have tonight. So as far as his wife was concerned, he was sleeping.

More clicking, moving around the kitchen now. Yeah, don't hurry in here. The fridge rattled. And while he'd been laying on his side looking out the apartment windows at the night sky, now he rolled over so he wouldn't have to see her face when she came in.

And it took minutes for her to come into the bedroom. At last though, she did, not being quiet. The door opening, and her whispering, "Josh." He didn't answer.

She was quiet for a long moment, standing in the bedroom doorway and staring at him. Then she was moving, the sound of her heels quiet on the bedroom's rug, going into her walk-in closet, closing the door and turning on the light. At least she was considerate not to blast light in his face and wake him up.

She was in there for minutes, then came out, walking across his field of vision, and he regarded her through very narrow eyes. She looked his way, but now headed into the bathroom. She was wearing her pajama shorts and her big Queens sweatshirt. She closed herself in the bathroom.

Now he rolled over the other way, returned his gaze to the nighttime sky. After 11 o'clock at night. That's when she comes home. After she was out with another man . . . He knew what she'd done.

The shower clicked on.

Wash it all off, Kimmy. Flush Devlin's smell off your skin . . .

Then the shower turned off again. What was she doing—washing her feet or something? The toilet flushed. The bathroom door opened, the frame of the window where he looked lighting up for a second before she turned the bathroom lights off.

He listened to her soft bare feet pad to the bed . . .



The remorse and regret had been intense once she'd left the Royal York suite. The IV treatment and the B12 shot had indeed been re-energizing. The wobbliness had gone from her legs, but she did ache from Devlin's huge size.

She'd been confident with Ellie, enjoying the luxury treatment, the perks of the job as it were. Ellie had gone, she'd dressed, then hustled out of the suite. The door closed behind her and locked. That was it. Over. Even if she wanted back in, she couldn't go in there now. And that was where the deed had been done. The door was locked; the act severed off from her life.

But as complete as she thought that sexual transaction with Devlin may have been, it was heading from the luxury suite past the floor's concierge to the elevator doors she felt the deep dread. Because while the act was done, now she was heading home to her husband. You could compartmentalize your actions, but there would be residue. Mental and physical. She hadn't showered. Hadn't showered, because she had to get home. She planned to

slip into the apartment, say hi, get in the shower quick. All she wanted was to get home. Then as the elevator descended, it gave her that sinking feeling in her stomach. And the sinking feeling got heavier knowing she was heading home after officially cheating on her husband. She'd danced around the truth all this time. All the things she'd already done with Devlin weren't really cheating, she'd told herself. He'd hardly got his dick in her at the party. He'd only put his fingers in her in their apartment. In the cargo container as well. And in his car outside the gym, sure, he'd got it inside her, but not deep. He didn't thrust. Not official sex. All that was over now. The act was done. And, yes, it was one time only, but that didn't change the fact that there was no going back now. It was done.

Back in her car, she sat wondering whether to put the clean panties back on. Pulled them out from under her car seat, held them bundled in both hands, fidgeting, running her thumbs over the satiny feel. Her heart started to thud with fear. Fear that Josh would know and hate her. She wouldn't be able to stand that. For the sake of sanity, she'd concentrated on the most imminent struggle: You didn't shower and the panties are clean. If you showered, you could put them on. You didn't. Now if you put them on, they'll smell like sex. And you may leak in them. Leak Devlin's semen. You can't put them in the hamper then. Are you going to do laundry as soon as you get home? Are you going to go in without panties? Sure, that would be great. Josh, desperate for you to get home, starts getting frisky right in the foyer like he did last time and you're not wearing panties. The best plan she could surmise was to drive home without them, put them on in the apartment parking lot and hope she didn't leak before she got to the bathroom and threw them in the hamper. One small hurdle crossed made her feel slightly better. But driving through the city only made her feel worse. Out of place. This wasn't really her city. She knew Kingston. She knew London. Toronto, only a little. North Toronto, where her office was, was a little more familiar. Downtown was the place now for her and Devlin. And then before she made it to the DVP something occurred to her. Mookie's Restaurant in Cabbagetown. She and Josh'd had a date there. It was a brightening thought, and she drove there feeling happier. And it certainly felt good to establish that connection in her mind with her husband. She parked street side, and looked in the quaint doors of the restaurant remembering that night that she and Josh—not fully committed as a couple, still just dating—

had gone there. Josh paid, a nervous gentleman, and she couldn't remember what they ordered. What else had they done that night? Had they come down here for a movie or a show? . . . Maybe a movie. But she definitely sat with him right in the front windows, and she imagined that fond youthful time with Josh fucking Waters playing out behind the glass. A guy she really, really loved. The storm clouds broke, her features wriggling and squirming, and she bawled. Sobbed and heaved and cried into her hands until the tears seeped through her fingers to the backsides of her hands. It was cleansing. She tidied up with napkins, knowing she couldn't take long because all she wanted was to be home with Josh, starting the Leaf, heading out of Cabbagetown and getting on the DVP.

Once she was on the DVP she was already feeling better. She'd had that reunion (at least in her memories) with the guy she loved. Putting the city and the fact she cheated on him behind her, she headed home. Couldn't wait to get home. But if she thought the dread was bad walking from the luxury suite to the elevators at the Royal York, it was worse walking from the apartment elevators to the apartment door. She was taking careful steps, hoping she wouldn't leak Devlin's semen into her clean panties before she got them to the hamper (but that would be impossible). Came in the apartment, and it was dark and empty and everything closed off. She knew he was home and that he hadn't gone out. That meant he was in bed. And that sunk her heart. She'd really hoped to have opened the apartment door to a cacophony of machine guns and video games and Josh and his friends yelling and having fun. Hoped maybe even Sophie would be here, too.

It was too much to hope for. She didn't deserve for it to be so easy. She just hoped it wasn't hard.

Josh's absence provoked a distinct fear the apartment was dark because he somehow knew what she'd done. The most likely was he was mad because she was late without letting him know she would be so late. So he'd gone to bed early to send her a message. Probably watched her on Find My Phone to know when he could turn the TV off. But what if it was worse than that? . . .

But how would he know what she'd done?

Another taunting text from Devlin?

But Devlin didn't send that text. She believed Devlin.

And that's where she was, believing the asshole who hurt her husband when her husband was a young man. Disbelieved her husband because she knew him, knew his nature. Loved him, but knew him to be hyperbolic. He told her Devlin texted taunts to stop her from seeing Devlin. He'd wanted her not to take the job at Stone Brokerage, but wanted her to be the one to say she wouldn't. Now it was too late.

Shit, and Josh was right—it was a terrible idea for her to take the job. Look what happened.

She lingered in the kitchen, gathering the nerve to go into the bedroom fearing she would find him not pretending to be asleep but with arms folded, furious, ready to kick her out. Maybe he was in the bedroom right now packing her bags.

Provoked by the awful thought of poor Josh throwing her things into her open suitcases was a particular image: his puzzled face wondering why something in particular was missing from her belongings.

What if he knew you wore the lingerie to work today—to the after-work meeting with Devlin Stone?

Oh holy shit, she thought, pressing her palm to her forehead in the hallway, heart thudding, pins and needles working in her hands and feet.

She'd opened the door bedroom door with great fear over what she'd find. Relieved to see Josh's huddled shape under the bedcovers. Stood and watched him for a long moment before whispering his name. He ignored her.

She changed in the closet, pleased to find her panties looking fresh, brought her things into the bathroom dressed in her sleeping sweats. Panties made it to the hamper without being mussed.

But when she turned on the shower, the hissing water signifying in her mind the act of getting clean, she heard it through Josh's ears. Josh would know why she was showering.

Sweatshirt pulled up, she examined her body, looking for marks, stains, or any sign. She wiped toilet paper to clean in her creases. There was a musky smell, but it was too late now to wash it away. One ass cheek was redder than the other, but Devlin's hand mark had faded. Her eyes looked hooded and sad, her vibrant post-fucking color had paled and she looked pallid now. She forced a smile on her face and didn't like it.

Now she padded to bed. Josh was turned in the opposite direction, facing the apartment window. Purposely showing her his back. She slipped under the covers, worked herself close to him but didn't touch him. She watched him sleep for a while—or at least pretend to sleep—his chest and shoulders moving up and down as he breathed. It would be better to close her eyes and go to sleep. Deal with this in the morning. An innocent wife back from a late business meeting, tired as heck, needing her sleep, finding her husband already in bed, crawling in next to him and passing out. They would deal with it in the morning. But she missed him. Her heart broke for him. Broke for him in this weird way—like he was her best friend, and she just found out his wife had cheated on him. But she was the wife, too. She wasn't two beings. She was one. She was his friend and his wife. She put her hand out, crawling it under the covers and finally resting her hand on his back, thumbing the frayed cotton of his old Coldplay T-shirt that he slept in. It was a tender and warm gesture. Not to be construed as the act of a cheating wife, but the act of a wife who knew she was out too late without sending word. Knew she'd done wrong.

But Josh's answer was horrifying.

“Don't touch me.”

She snapped her hand back, her chin dimpling and her lower lip quivering. Tears filled her eyes. Josh knew. She didn't know how, but Josh knew she'd cheated on him.

Cleanliness

It sounded like she might be crying. It wounded him to think of her hurting—but she fucking deserved it, so as much as he wanted to console her, he had to be strong.

She whispered, “I’m sorry I’m so late. Don’t be mad at me, Josh . . .” Her soft voice was pinched with sadness.

“I’m sleeping,” he said, not wanting to deal with this.

“Josh . . .?” Now he could hear quick little blurts of intake air as she tried not to burst out crying.

He rolled his eyes and let out an aggravated sound. Half-turned, looking up at the ceiling, he said over his shoulder, “It’s eleven o’clock, Kimmy. You didn’t even send me a message till after nine.”

“I know it’s late, I know . . . I said I’m sorry . . .”

Now he grumbled, shifted to look over at her. She was crying into one hand folded over her eyes. “Don’t . . . Come on, don’t cry . . .”

“I am sorry,” she said thickly.

“Why were you there so long? Is everything okay?”

“I’m fine,” she blubbered in a wet whisper.

“Then why are you crying?”

“You said not to touch you . . .”

“I’m fucking mad, Kimmy.” He swished around, faced her now, his beautiful wife, his amazing woman, curled in bed next to him, crying, hand over her eyes. “Don’t cry,” he said, and held her wrist.

“How could you say that to me?” she whined, then sobbed.

“Don’t, don’t, don’t,” he shushed, folded an arm around her. “I’m just so mad right now,” he whispered. She felt fever-hot in his arms. He hugged her.

“Oh my God, don’t ever say that . . .”

“I’m mad, Kimmy,” he stressed. “Don’t you get that?”

She sniffled, defended herself. “It was work, Josh. It was an important meeting.” Her breath was hot and wet against his neck.

“Four hours in a bar?”

“Not just in the bar,” she murmured.

Now he exhaled long and low. This was it. Was he ready for a lie? Was he ready to be confronted by an out-and-out lie? It would be proof she was cheating on him. “Look at me,” he said, moving back and easing her hand from her face. Her beautiful dark eyes met his, full of hurt and shining wet, the brown lit luminous by moonlight. He hoped a million times over she wouldn’t lie to him. “Where else did you go?” Her phone was at the Royal York the whole time.

“Up in their suite,” she said without looking away.

“Up in their suite? What—why? Whose suite?”

“The guys we met. We had two drinks at the bar, then . . . we went up to their suite for the meeting.”

“Why?” A delayed reaction he had to ignore as he still stared in her eyes: a sudden pounding of his heart, a thudding in his ear drums. Relief. If she had said they went anywhere else other than the Royal York, she’d be a liar. Her phone had never left the building.

“All their plans and paperwork were too big for the bar. They had all their stuff in their suite. We went up, had some drinks there, and they showed us what they wanted. I sat back and listened. It was mostly logistics at this point, but Devlin wanted me there.” Her chin dimpled, and she tucked it down as she began to cry again. She hugged herself to him, saying, “Believe me: I’d prefer to be at home here with you.”

He hugged her, rubbed a circle on her narrow back. “Were they Chinese?”

“Chinese from Italy,” she said. “Garments they manufacture there, ship here.”

“Four hours to figure out how to ship some dresses from Italy to Canada?”

She looked right in his eyes. “Why don’t you believe me? . . . What the hell do you think happened, Josh?”

“You couldn’t text me from the room? You let me sit here wondering where you were?”

“You knew where I was. I told you . . .” She touched a palm to his cheek. He grunted, pulled away. But not far. “Josh . . .”

“Look, I don’t . . .” he started, “It’s fine, just leave me alone and let me be mad.”

She shook her head no, pretty lips pursed. “You’re not allowed to be mad. Don’t.”

“Don’t tell me . . . I can be mad. I can’t help being mad,” he said, feeling the emotions flowing now. “I hate—fucking hate—Devlin Stone, and you work for him. You work for him, now you’re out at night with him.” He stared back, unflinching.

“Be calm, Josh, let’s talk. Don’t shout.”

“I’m not shouting.”

She said, “I work with Devlin so we can make our future. You know that’s the case. You said it before I ever said it. I wasn’t considering the job because it was with Devlin Stone. You were the one who said I could consider it. Now it sounds like that was a lie. You wanted me to consider it, then come back to you and say I wouldn’t take it. But that’s not fair. You should have told me what you really wanted. When I considered it, I considered it for the both of us. You said to think about it, so I assumed you could be a big man about it.”

“I am a big man about it,” he growled.

“I was impressed that you could be so big about it. Honestly. I felt so good you knew I could do this job and not . . .” She rolled her eyes around, searching for the words. “Not be a part of Devlin’s world.”

“I feel like you’re part of his world.” He sounded sulky. How could he be so mad—and have a right to be mad—and yet feel his grip on the argument slipping?

“I’m not, Josh. I don’t even want to be. I just want to do my work and get paid.”

“I am big about this, you know.”

“Not the last couple days, baby,” she said, touching his face tenderly again.

He held her wrist. “It’s you the last couple of days, Kimmy, you making me feel uncomfortable.”

She frowned. “Uncomfortable how? Because I responded to some work texts on a Saturday afternoon for half an hour, because I went out for a work meeting after five on a Monday night? It’s me how, Josh? It’s me because I’m doing the work I was hired to do?”

“Just let me be mad, okay? Maybe you’re right, but let me go to sleep and deal with it in my own way.”

“You don’t get to go to sleep,” she said, tears coming to her eyes again. “You’re not being fair. I don’t want you to be mad at me. I love you so much and I just want you to hold me right now.” Her face screwed up as she tried not to sob.

He made a pained face seeing her upset, and she sniffed and wiped the wet from her eyes.

“I’m sorry, Kimmy.”

“It’s not fair,” she whispered. “We said I should do this, I quit my other job and you . . . you make it so hard for me.”

“Okay-okay, Kimmy, I’m sorry, okay? . . .”



What she wanted more than anything was for her husband to hold her. She was ashamed of her secret and no one in her life could support her like Josh could. Only, it was from Josh the secret was withheld. For whatever reason, that truth made her feel more alone than she could ever remember feeling. Maybe when her Mom died. That was a scary and lonely time. But her sister’d been there. Not her father so much, but at least her and her sister were there for Pop, and that was support in its own way—giving as nourishing as receiving.

Now she snaked against Josh, desperate to feel his arms going around her—needing his arms around her. She pressed her face into the hollow of his neck, feeling his chin score over the crown of her head.

“The whole time I was there all I could think was how you were going to be mad when I got home.”

It was like he could see how he'd put pressure on her. He rolled his head around, grumbling. “Come here,” he said, and put his arms around her. She fell into him, bewilderingly astounded to be accepted and held and loved. Even though she'd cheated on him, lied to his face, shamed him and their future family. She didn't deserve his comfort, but it felt so good right now. She cried real tears on his shoulder, and he rubbed her back.

“I'm such an asshole,” he sighed.

“No, don't say that. I don't think that. I know it's hard for you, I know. I'm trying to be good.” Her voice had thickened with sadness and she sniffled again, wiping her weeping eyes on Josh's cotton shoulder.

With his arms around her at last, she felt that support she craved. That love. But shame, too. So much shame.

Her arms snaked around him now, slipping under his and hooking behind his back. She pressed herself into his chest, her chin and cheek digging in until he said Ow. She kissed his chest, rubbed his back. She said, “I know I should have called. I should've texted. But I was trying to work. He hardly even needed me, but I had to be there. I had to listen to everything they said. I had to listen to the things that they would say to each other . . . In case it was in Chinese or something. I had to pay attention the whole time. Even when we weren't talking about work—that's how it is, you have to be careful what people are saying to each other even when they're not using words. And the worst, Josh? . . . I know I shouldn't have been texting when we were at lunch with Pop and Susan. I know it now. I know it because I didn't text you when I was with those guys in the suite. They had my full attention, but it's you who has to have my full attention. And my dad, too. I don't want to be like that, Josh, I swear . . .”

“Aw, Kimmy . . .”

Now he hugged her tighter, and she hooked a leg over his hip and clung to him. “I'm so sorry. I just love you so much. I felt bad, I know I texted and

said I was leaving at nine . . . But they just kept talking . . . And then on the way home . . . Remember when we went on a date into Toronto, and we went to that restaurant in Cabbagetown—Mookie’s?”

He nodded, his chin moving against the top of her head. He hugged her and stroked his hands on her back.

“I drove out there, just to look at the place. Isn’t that weird? Not long, just parked out front and tried to remember what else we did that night . . .”

“Hayao Miyazaki movie.”

“Was that what it was?”

“I wanted you to go with me.”

“That’s right,” she said, burrowing her face in and hugging him tighter. “I don’t really remember the movie . . .”

“Princess Mononoke.”

“Oh yeah . . . Anyway, I just remembered what it was like when we were dating and how I was sitting at that table doing everything I could to make sure you liked me.”

Josh chuckled. “You should know that I probably had it ten times worse than you did.”

She giggled, snorted, then sniffled. “It was important for you to like me, Josh. I was so in love with you . . .”

Josh squeezed her. “God, Kimmy, I needed this. I need this so bad. We have to talk. I was going crazy tonight . . .”

“I’m sorry. I really messed up and I know it. Okay?”

“I’ve never felt like I was losing you more than this week.”

She stiffened, shocked. “Losing me,” she said, incredulous. “Josh, what the hell does that mean?”

“I feel like you’re moving away from me.”

“Josh, I’m moving closer to you.”

“I know, I know . . . But I can’t help how I feel.”

“Josh, seriously, I’m working for Devlin Stone. Do you know how hard that is? And I’m doing it for us . . .”

“I know,” he said again. “I just need you to . . . I needed to hear you say it. I need to know you’re on my side and not his.”

“I’m not on his side at all, Josh. I’m on your side. It feels so good to be in your arms.”

“It feels so good to hold you.”

“I need this so bad,” she said and kissed his neck. Even in the worst of times, she could rely on Josh. He was her rock.

Now they were squirming together, arms moving, hands stroking, her foot rubbing the back side of his calf. She kissed his neck, and he was rolling to get his weight over top of her.

Her heart pounded. She didn’t know if she could do this right now. What if it hurt going in and she cried out? What if it hurt so bad she couldn’t let Josh do it? Devlin was huge, and Josh was so much smaller—but what if it stung like when she’d peed?

But she couldn’t say no . . .

“Oh, Josh . . .” Her mind was racing, wanting there to be a way out of this.

Her hands went down his back, slipped under the waistband of his pajama pants and grabbed his butt cheeks, then her right hand swooping quickly around and diving in between his legs to find him hard as a rock. But he

was slipping from her grip. His kisses traveling her chest now. He shoved his hands up the front of her sweatshirt. She wore nothing underneath. Her favorite dorm room flannel from university so soft she loved the way it touched her skin. He pushed it upward, and she scooted left and right to help him get it off. While she struggled to free it from one arm, he was sucking on her nipples, kissing her chest and her stomach.

“Oh no . . .” He kissed her navel, ran his tongue around it, suckled. She ran her hands through his hair, dragged her nails on his scalp. “Oh Josh, don’t . . .”

Her voice was a whisper. The act of protesting alarmed her. What if her saying not to do it made Josh realize the truth . . . Why would she not want him to do this . . .?

“I’m not clean, Josh . . .”

But Josh had his fingers in the fronts front of her pajama shorts, pulling them down, kissing lower where the skin was revealed, kissing each hip bone, and she began to tingle, began to feel good, but she couldn’t let him . . . could she . . .?

“Josh, don’t, I’ve been at work all day . . . I’m not clean, baby . . .”

And Josh wasn’t listening, sitting on his knees between her legs and pulling her shorts down. She flailed her legs, rotating at the hips, letting him pull them down. She pulled one leg out but left her knee folded over. He scooted his hand between her knees and opened her legs, lowered, kissed her navel again.

“Baby, Josh, it’s been such a long day . . . I should clean . . .”

But Josh’s eyes were glazed; he was robotic, and she knew he wanted to do this and was going to do it.

“Josh, baby, let’s have sex . . .”

But maybe that wasn’t a good idea either.

Now her heart pounded even faster as his kisses traveled lower, working just above her pubic hair. His chin rustled. She felt his skin graze across her sore sex. Felt the slight pang of injury from Devlin's large size and thunderous pounding he'd delivered.

"Oh Josh, Josh . . ."

And now she was caressing Josh's head. Closing her eyes, face scrunched up. Hoping upon hope he wouldn't know what had happened. There was nothing to do. Couldn't have sex and couldn't deny her husband's oral pleasure. She would submit . . . Submit and hope that whatever Josh discovered, she could survive it . . .

Then the underside point of his tongue ran through the scrape of her pubic hair and parted her furrowed petals.

"Oh God," she blurted, feeling no pain at all, only pleasure. Loving the touch of her husband's tongue against that part of her. He took her opening fully in his mouth and suckled, ran his tongue through her split, twirled it over her clitoris and got her legs shaking. She grabbed fistfuls of her own hair, her elbows pointed toward the ceiling as she writhed under her husband's tongue.

Her stomach fluttered and her breath went airy. Josh sucked on her pussy hungrily, unambiguously. Slurping, growling, his hands grabbing her butt cheeks to push her sex into his driving tongue and sucking mouth.

But he didn't know what he was tasting. Didn't know what had happened between her legs tonight. She cried out as a wild ride of pulse-racing blotted her conscience. How awful she'd been. How loved she was. How hard she'd been fucked. How good and deep she'd been fucked . . .

Josh was burying his tongue in the truth. Josh was tasting Devlin's semen. Tasting the residue of how wet his wife got for a man she didn't even like. What would Josh think if he knew Devlin made her pussy squirt? That his bully could make his wife come in a way like she'd never experienced?

“Oh Josh, your tongue feels so good, you feel so good, baby, oh Josh, I’m so dirty . . .”

He growled and fed off her.

“Josh, oh baby, what are you doing to me? Oh God, you’re going to make me come, oh baby, you’re sucking me so fucking good . . .”

Feast

The hot furled membranes that cushioned her tight opening were salty and distinctly copper. She stunk. She smelled sweaty and dirty. Her pussy had been used. Devlin had fucked Kimmy's pussy with his huge cock. Stale greasy semen smell flooded his nostrils.

Kimmy gasped, "Put your tongue deep, baby, put your tongue in me . . ."

And he did. Shoved his pointed tongue right inside her, felt her heat, tasted her filth. All of it in his head.

No idea what to look for in a cheating wife's pussy—but this had to be it. Wasn't it? The copper taste—tiny broken blood vessels in her membranes after being pounded by a giant cock. The funky taste. More than just sweat. It was sex. Wasn't it? Semen?—he didn't know . . . He could smell Kimmy's sex smell in his nose. And that didn't happen from laying next to him in bed and crying. And the crying . . .? Crying from regret. She'd cheated on her husband, and now her heart was hurting.

He sobbed into her sex, his mouth filled with her pussy. Her pubic hairs scored his palette. His tongue probed and pulsed against her, and Kimmy writhed against him like she never had before from his mouth. Her fists filled with his hair, driving her hips purposely into his mouth. Loving it. Crying out with intense pleasure. Tears squeezed from his squinted eyes and mingled with saliva and her juices. And maybe Devlin's semen.

He hugged her legs—hooked arms around her thighs and squeezed her legs against his ears. Riding her pumping hips. Crying into her sex.

But she was with him.

She'd cried because she loved him. And the love was real. And, Jesus fucking Christ, she didn't have sex with Devlin. It was like he wanted her to do it. Wanted it to have happened. Right now his cock throbbed and pulsed between his thighs. She was just late getting home. That's all. She went to a hotel suite to help Devlin figure logistics with some Chinese garment merchants from Italy.

Or did she?

"Oh God," he blurted, gasping for air.

Kimmy thrashed. Grabbed his ears and pulled his mouth to her pussy again. "Don't stop, Josh, don't stop . . ."

He dove his tongue inside her. He didn't care if Devlin had fucked her. Her heart was his. He knew it. And he wouldn't let her go. He would fight for her.

"God, Josh, don't stop. Oh my God, oh my fucking God, baby, I'm going to come, oh baby, I'm going to come . . ."

Now the thighs pressed to his ears squeezed tighter. Kimmy's hands were pinched between her thighs and his head, her knuckles digging into his scalp as her thighs vice-locked on his head and he sucked at her sopping coppery flesh. She bucked and trembled, and his mouth filled with a sudden tinkling spate. He dug his fingers into the outsides of her thighs and continued to suck and drink from her. She was coming. Really, really, coming. Squirting in his mouth.

He moaned an ecstatic, victorious sound, sucked her harder, her meager labia squirming between his hungry lips, so slick he couldn't get a grip on them any longer. He tongued her instead. Tongued her deep thinking he didn't care if Devlin had fucked her tight little pussy tonight, he loved her just the same, would always love her.

Kimmy's ankles locked on his back and she squeezed his head till he couldn't hear. But traveling through the insides of her body and vibrating in the muscles of her thighs was the distinct wails of his wife's crying

pleasure. He'd given it to her. He'd delivered her to this ecstatic height. He squeezed more tears, happier ones, knowing this was in his head, knowing he would torture himself to death with this doubt if he wasn't careful. As Kimmy's leg lock weakened finally, he kissed her slippery labia softly, and she cooed, stroked his hair. The flicks of his tongue got her stomach jumping, and she hissed quick intakes like her pussy was sensitive. And that sent off the dread again. The absolute stomach churning fear she'd fucked another man. The lips he kissed right now had stretched tonight around his hated bully's huge cock. Could probably barely cling to his thick size as he gored in and out of her sacred space with his mighty meat piston, Kimmy wailing like she'd just done.

"Shit, oh," he gasped, as the wild thought did something more than he expected. He jumped up, scrambled over her body, thumbing his erection down, aiming it for her wet little slit.

Kimmy, alarmed, not knowing what he would do, ran nails on his hips and stomach, saying, "What, Josh, what are you . . .?"

And him getting the head of his cock in her nest, and her closing her legs, not accepting, saying, "Not now, baby, oh, baby, I'm sensitive . . ."

And it didn't matter anyway, because he was spewing his seed in frosted lines across the tangle of her pubic hair.

"Josh, oh baby," she whispered, scooting her butt closer to accept his seed splashed on her sex. Her sex devastated by a man with a huge cock, but wanting the soothing balm of her husband's load as a blessing . . .

The dark thoughts would destroy him, but Devlin's black magic had intertwined into his reality, and now for the first time since Tiff's party he wondered if there was a small chance he'd actually asked Devlin Stone to fuck his wife.

Kimmy's grip went on him, taking over his pleasure, her hand wrapped on his throbbing manhood and softly stroking the last spurts from him.

“Joshy, baby, oh baby, that was so hot,” she whispered, watching her hand on his cock. His meager cock compared to her boss.

He panted now, and his pulse thundered in his temples. “That was crazy,” he gulped. “You came so hard . . .”

“So did you,” she laughed and gave his cock a squeeze.

Then: “Little Josh had an accident.” Two more squeezes on his Little Josh, and she kissed his arm, chuckling to herself.

His brow lowered and his breath chugged like he might cry. His feelings had just been smashed on the floor like they were a vase his wife’d held over her head and dashed onto the hardwood. Instead of crying, he chewed his inner cheek, snuffling, and a steady throb renewed between his legs. His softening member pulsed in her grip, returned to glorious iron.

Much smaller than Devlin’s when she held it earlier tonight...

No!—he had to stop, stop, stop . . .

Without asking, Kimmy stroked again. Gripping him good, going up and down like she knew this was a brand new hard-on that needed release just like the first. He was on his hands and knees over her, Kimmy sitting up awkwardly and jerking him off with his first load cooling on her pussy and stomach.

He hugged her head to his stomach and looked to the ceiling. He said, “It’s not little.”

“What?”

“It’s not little, Kimmy,” he muttered, wrangling his emotions, trying not to betray the hurt he felt.

“It’s not little,” she whispered. “Little as in you’re Big Josh, and it’s junior. It’s not small. It’s not, baby. It’s so big . . .”

“No, Kimmy, don’t . . .” That was a dumb lie. A prostitute’s lie.

“What, Josh, tell me what you want—I’ll do it, I’ll do anything . . .” She pulled her head from his stomach, turned her beautiful face up to regard him and show him an earnest expression. She wanted to know what he wanted. “I’m all ticklish and sensitive now, Josh, I don’t know what you did with your tongue, but that was so crazy . . . I want you to come, okay? I want to make you come again. Want me to suck it?”

He shook his head no. Tucked her head to his belly again, looked away. He muttered: “He was on top of you.”

Voice high and worried: “What?”

“Devlin was on top of you . . .”

“When?”

“At Tiff’s party,” he said. Kimmy’s stroke slowed. He humped his cock through her hand.

Kimmy whispered, “Yeah . . .” She looked up.

“You said he humped you. You said . . .”

When he hesitated, she urged him: “It’s okay . . .”

“You said . . . he humped you and you said . . . he was hard.”

Her mouth tucked to one side, and she averted her eyes. She nodded.

“He was hard?”

She whispered, “Yeah. He was hard. I told you . . .”

“You felt him?”

She nodded again, saying, “I’m sorry,” cheeks dimpling, eyebrows tenting—an expression of sorrow.

“You didn’t do it.”

“I know. I’m sorry it happened. It’s not right . . .”

“No. You said . . .”

“Said what?”

He hesitated, not wanting to walk this route with his wife by his side. This was the path he walked alone. But she wanted to hear it. Invited him to tell her. He knew she wanted to hear it, and the look in her eyes . . . “Said you saw it, too.”

Her hand slowed again. She looked down. “Not really.”

“Did you or didn’t you?”

Her stroke resumed, and she looked up, but didn’t meet his eyes. “The shape of it. In his pants.”

Now he nodded. His cock hardened, and he could feel its pulse against the grip of Kimmy’s hand. She must feel what this did to him. He tried to swallow but only gulped. Kimmy stroked still, and he rode the ecstasy of her words, while his wife looked up and studied him. She wanted to know more, and fuck did he want to tell her, spill his beans all over the place. But his breaths came shaky and the horrifying images he loved to play behind his eyes of his wife seeing Devlin’s cock—the thing he’d feared so long—began to wisp away with her eyes on him. He moaned and thrust his cock into her stroking hand.

“Josh . . .?”

The pressure built behind his balls and the more it built the more he craved to say what he wanted, to hear back from his wife what he feared.

“What did you . . . what did you think?”

“Think about what?”

“What you saw.”

She cocked her head, looked concerned. “Devlin?”

“Forget it . . .”

“Baby . . . no, tell me . . .”

“Do you ever think about what you saw?”

“What do you mean?”

He looked away, grunted as she stroked him faster and tightened her grip.

She urged: “Tell me, Josh . . .”

“Do you ever . . . think about him that way?”

“No, Josh . . .”

“Tell me—”

“I don’t, baby.”

He changed tack. “You saw his bulge?”

“I know, I’m sorry . . .”

“Was it . . .” Oh God. “Big?”

She ignored him and a swell of shame and regret flooded his mind and he scrunched his face up, wishing he could take it back.

Her grip tightened further, and she stroked his cock vigorously, getting his hips rocking. He shooed the embarrassment, concentrated on getting his ejaculation over with . . .

Then, unprompted: “It was really big, baby.”

A tremble shuddered through his body and his exhale quivered. Kimmy’s words drew a silky black blanket over his sexuality and he felt on the verge

of losing control.

He was so close, and now he didn't want to be close—wanted this dark pleasure to go on forever and ever. He gasped, “You never, hah, mm, think about it?”

“No, baby, not . . .”

“Not what?”

“Not really. No, I don't . . .”

“You saw his big b-bulge . . .? And you never . . . never think about-bout it . . .?”

He hated the words. Hated the awful black thoughts vomiting from his mouth and put into Kimmy's ears—into his wife's psyche. But it felt so incredibly good. And it was just a glimmer of the light that shone behind his door. But just letting it peep out at her, letting Kimmy get the tiniest glimpse at what was going on inside him, felt so huge and incredible and joyous. In the back of his mind he knew he would regret it, but with Kimmy's hand jerking big bright pleasure, the bad was blotted.

She whispered again, “Of course I don't,” and he looked down between his legs at her pretty hand giving him pleasure. She wanted him to have pleasure. He could have it if he'd let her know. She had long graceful fingers, but what he focused on was her grip. Thumb and first two fingers jerking off the end inches of his regular-size dick. Her ring finger and pinky finger extended out in a dainty pose. And he thought of her grip on Devlin. What that would be like. How her grip couldn't handle that monster. His stomach tightened and squirmed, his cock flexed in her grip.

“Yeah?” She gasped, knowing he was close, “Come on, baby, come on, do it.” She craned her neck, nibbled on his earlobe, her slender body touching his. Embracing him. Loving him. Wanting him to have the pleasure he craved.

Chest tight, he wheezed, “Tell me you do . . .”

“Tell you what—what do you want me to tell you, baby?”

“Tell me you think . . .” He couldn’t even finish.

Now Kimmy gave her strokes a longer trajectory. Still going fast, but dragging his whole shaft. “Come on, Josh,” she said, “one more time for me, I want you to come . . .”

He sucked in his stomach, stuck his dick out as far as it would go. Show her everything he had. Every inch. “Tell me you do,” he grunted again, “think about it . . .”

She sighed, bit his ear again, kissed his neck. “I think about it, Josh,” she whispered right in his ear.

He jolted. It was going to happen, and it was going to be huger than he could even anticipate.

“I think about it, Josh, I wonder what it looks like . . .”

“Oh fuck, Kimmy, fuck, fuck, fuck, God,” he cried, and he gripped her knee tighter. The pressure was escaping. The release was huge but ominous. “Oh my God . . .”

“I think about it—I think about it all the time . . . how big it is . . .”

Then he was bucking, jumping between her legs, his legs quivering, mind frazzled like it’d tuned to a static station on a shitty old radio. He grabbed her wrist to stop her stroke because the ticklish pleasure was insane. He was coming. Pulsing more semen. And Kimmy cooed happily in his ear, loving that he was coming for her again. She snaked her arms around him and held him as he buckled toward her. Let her cradle him while he still ejaculated weak spurts. The orgasm itself was far more spectacular than the propulsion of his sexual product. His heart pounded, his mind felt ripped wide. And even while he rode Mr. Dirty Toad’s Wild Adventure Ride, he began already to regret making her say that. He wished he could take it all back. So as soon as he could, he pushed away the pleasure of the orgasm, drew in a big breath, pushed himself to sit upright so he wasn’t held in his wife’s arms

like a little child. He straightened, chuckled awkwardly, gripped his slick cock.

“Sorry,” he said.

“Sorry for what?” she said and hugged him, kissed his shoulder.

“I don’t know why I said any of that.”

“It’s okay,” she soothed him.

“I didn’t even really want you to say that.”

“It’s okay, believe me, Josh. Everybody’s got things that they don’t understand about themselves.”

“I’m so embarrassed,” he said, rubbed his forehead, grabbed a handful of the hair on top of his head.

“No-no, don’t say that,” she said, kissing one side of his neck, hand palming the other. She was so affectionate and loving. And all he could think was how much she meant to him. A few minutes ago he was a hundred percent convinced she’d cheated on him. A hundred percent convinced he could taste another man’s cock and the abuse it had delivered to her tight little pussy. But now it seemed all so stupid. So stupid to think that. She wouldn’t let him go down on her if she cheated. It was ridiculous to consider. And the care and the love he felt being held in her arms . . .? Now all he was left with was the fact that he’d blurted out the stupidest dirty-thrilling thought that hid in the recesses of his mind. And it couldn’t be taken back.

He punched his leg. “I can’t believe I said that.”

“Don’t do that, Josh. Don’t. I’ll say that if you want. I don’t care. I don’t, I swear.” Now she hugged his waist, rested her chin in the hollow of his neck. He cupped her cheek, thumbed her cheekbone.

He said, “It just came out of nowhere.” What a lie.

“It’s okay, baby. It didn’t bother me . . .”

“What a bizarre thing to come into my mind.”

“Hey,” she said, straightening up now. She waited for him to turn to face her. She said, “Don’t be ashamed. Whatever you want me to do, I’ll do it. Remember: we’re going to communicate . . .? If you want me to say something that works for you, I’ll say it. I’d love to say it. I don’t think anything bad about it.”

“Well, I think something bad about it. I fucking hate that guy—why would I want you to say that?”

“The brain’s a messed up place, you know it.”

“It’s the last thing I want to hear.”

“Come here,” she said, rubbing his chest again, hugging him. “Don’t make too much of it. If you want me to say things like that, I’ll say them. Just ask. Okay?”

“I don’t want to do that to you. I don’t want to put that in your head.”

“Put what in my head?”

“Make it sexual. Sexualize him.”

“I know you don’t . . .”

“He . . . he assaulted you, and I got off . . .” He couldn’t finish, looking away and shaking his head.

“He didn’t assault me, and I’m not offended by what you wanted me to say. It’s just between us. If something turns you on, I want to know about it.”

“You don’t think that was weird?”

“Weird, yes, but I know you. And I love you more than anything. I know where shit like that comes from. Okay?” She patted his chest.

“My God,” he said, “that was huge. Really huge.” Now he managed an uncomfortable chuckle. Somehow she’d made him feel better.

“I can’t believe you came twice,” she said, rubbing a circle on his back. “That was so hot.”

“You came hard too,” he said.

“Now you’re embarrassing me.”

“Has that ever happened before?”

“Have I ever come before?” She turned up her nose and raised an eyebrow.

“No, not that. You know, like you . . .”

“What—” she said, “Did something happen?”

“Yeah . . . You . . . Sorry, I thought you knew, but you, like . . .” He whispered: “Squirted.”

“Oh,” she said, looking away then biting on her lower lip like she was embarrassed. “Oh okay.”

“Has it ever happened before?”

“I guess it can happen,” she said, shrugging a shoulder.

He said, “Hey—everything okay with you now?”

She nodded.

He said, “It’s so true that we have to communicate. I thought all these terrible things all night long, and then I shut down.”

“When you shut down, and you say bad things, it breaks my heart. And that ___”

“I don’t want you to hurt, Kimmy. I’m sorry.”

“No. It’s not that I hurt that’s bad, it’s that I don’t . . . if I’m hurt, I don’t know how to make things better. All I do is hurt . . .”

“I didn’t mean to hurt you.”

“And I never mean to hurt you, either,” she said, embraced him, one sperm-covered hand held out. He kissed her mouth. She made happy sounds while they kissed.

When their mouths parted, she chuckled, said, “I really need to get cleaned up now . . .”

Toothpaste & Citrus

They were playful together in the bathroom. Ran a shower together and got in under the hot spray. She washed his penis and balls, kissed him, turned around and Josh scrubbed her with soap all over. Even getting in between her thighs and being careful not to get soap inside her vagina. And, god, she loved him so much. He rubbed her back with love and she felt restored. It was safe with him in the confine of their small apartment bathroom. Very far removed from the woman she'd been a few hours ago having wild and incredible sex with the man who was her boss and her husband's high school nemesis, the two of them naked in bed in one of the city's finest luxury suites.

She flinched when Josh's soapy hand went over the spot where she'd got her B12 shot. She kept her right arm closed to hide the IV mark in the crook of her arm. Josh didn't care. Those weren't the spots on her body he paid attention to. He spent most of the time washing her butt crack, her pussy and her breasts and nipples. They said little, but often chuckled.

When they were both clean, Josh got out, and she stayed in while he dried. That was when the bad thoughts came again. What her husband had asked her of Devlin. Did you see his big cock? And her dying to admit it but afraid, then knowing deep down that was what Josh wanted to hear. The crazy thrill of telling him. The trick of honesty. Josh coming being told the truth he thought was fantasy. Feeling his cock swell in her hand as he came, knowing he was aroused by his wife's badness. Or maybe not badness. Maybe it was her vulnerability that thrilled him. His poor wife, the victim of his bully the same way he was. Helpless Kimmy, he'd thought when he came in her hand and onto her stomach again. She preferred to think it was badness over helplessness. But then when she was beginning to feel that

heavy arousal between her legs (an endless cycle today despite the complete satisfaction delivered, even by her husband), she stepped out into the held-out towel between her husband's waiting arms. He dried her, but she took over, wrapped herself in the shroud of terry. Josh headed out to get dressed. She towel-dried the damper parts of her hair that were wetted despite being tied up on top of her head.

In the closet, she redressed in soft cotton clothes, fresh shorts and a new sweatshirt. Home things. Kimmy and Josh things.

Josh changed the sheets, put on fresh bedding. She called out from the closet, asking him if he ate dinner. He said no.

“Do you want me to make you something?”

“It's too late to eat. You didn't eat?”

“Barely,” she said. “I picked at some stuff in the suite, but I was too busy paying attention, and trying not to look like a woman who ate even though she was hungry.”

“That sounds weird.”

“Got to be on your game,” she said.

“You're going to eat now?”

“I guess it's late. Maybe a smoothie . . . You want one?”

“No way.”

She tugged her clothes into place, swiped her phone off the dresser and tucked it in her sweatshirt's pouch, huddled up and went out in the bedroom, told Josh she'd just be a few minutes while he settled into a comfortable position in the newly made bed.

Even though the awful deed was done—she'd finally had sex with Devlin—there was one storyline of the day left open, and she wanted it tied off. An ache in her stomach needed it complete.

In the kitchen she gathered kale and carrots and brought out some honey and ginger, put all the items to be chopped onto a cutting board, removed her phone from the sweatshirt pouch and left it face up on the counter for now. Got her knife, dragged out the juicer and plugged it in, touched her phone screen to check the messages she'd received this evening. Work stuff, but nothing from Devlin since the Royal York. She chopped ginger, put it in the blender. Touched her screen and brought up her Messenger. Chopped up kale and carrots into manageable sizes. Threw all the ingredients into the Vitamix. Texted Devlin one simple statement.

Kimmy: deep secret

Now she moved around the kitchen like she hadn't just texted Devlin, forgetting she'd done it, getting apple juice, some Realemon and adding it to her juicer. A text came. She leaned through the pass through, saw the hall was empty. She read the text.

Devlin: you get home safe?

Kimmy: safe and sound

Devlin: everything good?

She snuffled, leaned forward again, the hall still empty. She texted a reply but didn't send it. Tucked the phone back in her pouch and gave the

Vitamix a few good pulses. Brought out her phone and sent the text without editing it.

Kimmy: I got Josh to go down on me

Then regretted it. Really regretted it. Heat blazed on her cheeks and ears. Her ears began to ring, and she felt lightheaded. She tucked her phone away and wished she'd just stuck to making a juice. But she didn't even come out here for a juice, damn it, and she knew it. She came out here to text Devlin and tell him the awful thing that had happened. And how much it turned her on.

Do not tell him that.

No. She wouldn't. Just tell him the ending to what he'd instructed. Ever the good employee, she'd exceeded expectations. Not only had she gone home without washing, her lover's stink on her, his seed deposited deep in her belly, her unsuspecting husband had put his tongue there. Sucked her there. Now her knees shook with the awfulness and she leaned on the counter. Her phone vibrated.

Devlin: I'm calling you put your phone on mute

Kimmy: DO NOT CALL!

Shit, shit, shit.

She squeezed her thighs together, biting her lower lip and fighting with the renewed aching knot tightening between her thighs. Fuck. She went to

contacts, dialed Devlin. He answered on the first ring.

“You’re fucking killing me, Chang.”

“I know,” she whispered, peering down the hall again. “I can’t believe it.”

“You’re so fucking hot. I want with you with me right now.”

“Where are you?”

“Pulled off the highway. Tell me what happened.”

“No, I can’t—I have to get back to bed.”

“He ate you out?”

A gasp: “Yeah.”

“I’m hard as a rock right now for you. Where the hell did you come from?”

“I don’t know,” she whispered, chuckling, hand cupped over her mouth.

“He’s in bed right now?”

“Yeah. We had sex. Well, kind of. He was kissing me, and I pushed . . . pushed his head down there . . .”

“Tell me more.”

“I can’t, I have to—”

“Kimmy, come on . . .”

“That’s it. He went down on me. I meant to have a shower and then I didn’t have a chance, and then we kind of fought and the next thing I know . . .”

“Touch yourself . . .”

“No way,” she said, bouncing on her knees like she had to pee. Only the urge had nothing to do with urinating. The urge was deep and carnal and so, so strange.

“Did you come in his mouth?”

Oh god. Her stomach squirmed. “Yeah.”

“You are the baddest girl I’ve ever known. Fucking ever, Kimmy.”

“Yeah?” Muscles tightened in her core. Kegels. She pressed her knees together and humped her hips against the hard rounded edge of the countertop.

“So bad. So perfect.”

“I gotta go.” She leaned her tummy on the counter, checking the hallway again. Then: “He asked me . . .”

Devlin waited. Said, “Asked you what? Come on and tell me . . .”

“Asked me if . . . asked me if you had a big . . .”

“Oh fuck . . .”

She gasped, felt her labia slippery now. “He wanted to know if you had a big cock.” She gasped again when the words had slipped from her quivering lips.

“Wait—why did he think . . .?”

“Through your pants . . . I told him, I told him at Tiff’s you had an erection.”

“He’s thought about that?”

“Yeah, he wanted me to tell him while I jerked him off on my stomach . . .” Her free hand rubbed a circle on her bare tummy, up under her sweatshirt.

“Fuck—I got my cock out. You are fucking crazy, Kimmy, crazy . . .”

“Your cock’s out?” Her hand slipped under her shorts and found her wetness, and she gasped into the phone again.

“Touch yourself . . .”

“I am . . .”

“What did you tell him about my cock?”

“I told him it was big.”

“You saw it in my pants.”

“Yeah, and you were . . . oh God . . . humping it on my stomach.”

“It wasn’t in my pants . . .”

“No, it definitely wasn’t . . .”

“Let me hear your pussy . . .”

“What—how? . . .”

“Put the phone near that sweet little thing.”

“Oh no, no way,” she sighed, but her hand with the phone was dropping and she was leaning and checking the hall. Eyes glued to make sure she didn’t get caught, both hands were under her shorts now, one holding her phone. The fingers of the other hand strummed her labia. They were full and slippery and Devlin was hearing how wet she was. She brought back the phone. “Did you hear it?”

“I’m going to come.”

“You’re jerking off?”

“Fuck, yeah.”

“You’re jerking that big cock?” She pushed two fingers inside herself, felt the ache left by the enormous thing her lover held in his big masculine hand right now somewhere off the highway between Toronto and Kingston.

“I’m thinking about you,” he said.

“I’m thinking about you,” she whispered.

“Come for me . . .”

“Oh no way,” she whispered, but oh yeah, it was close—it was going to happen again tonight. Then she whispered: “Let me hear you jerk it.”

She listened as the phone’s mic jostled, then rustled against fabric. Now she could hear a slick skin-shuffling sound, and a wet clicking she imagined would be from his sticky pee-hole opening and closing while he stroked that magnificent thing. Her knees buckled, and she squatted below the counter, one hand still in her shorts. “That sounds so fucking hot,” she hissed into the phone.

“Come for me,” he growled, phone back at his dirty mouth.

“I’m going to . . .”

“Think of what I did to that little kitty tonight and think of Josh running his tongue into our filth . . .”

She moaned and sighed, squinted her eyes shut, forehead pressed to cabinetry while her fingers plunged a curved shallow depth into her pussy. “He licked it all up . . .”

“You fed it to him . . .”

“He came while he ate me . . .”

“Jesus Christ, Kimmy, I’m going to fucking lose my mind . . .”

“Ah, ah-ha,” she laughed, her middle finger pad swirling over a delightful note inside her canal, “he shot his load all over . . . all over . . .”

“Shot his little load . . .”

She bucked, rocked her head on the cabinet door, the orgasm scooping out her mind now, flipping it over, “Oh god, his little load . . .”

“From that little dick . . .”

“Oh Devlin, I’m coming . . .”

“Tell me,” he grunted.

“His little dick drizzled all over my p-pussy—” The orgasm rocked her and she squeezed breath in her lungs, held on tight to consciousness while trying not to cry out. In her ear, Devlin growled and roared, huffed breath. Her lover was coming. Both of them heaved breath in each other’s ears for half a minute. Then Devlin chuckled, and she did too.

She went to her knees and elbows on the kitchen floor, phone still pressed to her ear. “Wow,” she laughed and Devlin returned a throaty chuckle.

“Yeah,” Devlin agreed.

“You came?”

“Fuck, did I.”

Now she fully exhaled, pulled her hair out of her eyes. “So hot.”

“So hot . . . Now go to bed, Chang, your husband’s waiting for you.”

She chuckled at the sheer badness of it. “Yeah. Good night.”

“See you tomorrow.”

She chuckled again. “See you.” She was smiling when she shut off the call.



What he thought about while he waited for her to make herself one of those disgusting kale smoothies was how she didn't seem that surprised she'd squirted. If she'd ever done that before in their sex life, he wouldn't have forgotten about it. In fact, the date was going down in his mental journal to be remembered. Monday, August 10: the date he'd made Kimmy Chang squirt. That was a huge accomplishment. Wasn't it? If she'd squirted, that must mean the orgasm was bigger than usual. Or maybe it didn't work that way. If ever he'd anticipated there could possibly be a day where his wife squirted, the way he pictured it going down was Kimmy being shocked and amazed at her husband's ability, and also super-grateful. But tonight when it happened she was unbothered.

Oh yeah, I guess I squirted. It can happen.

It can happen? With whom? Did some other guy make her squirt one time? That thought made him mad, thinking of her sharing some intimate moment like that with some faceless guy he hated on auto. And if that were the case, well, then, wouldn't it stand to reason the whole time she'd been with him she'd wondered why Josh Waters couldn't make her do that amazing thing? Did she think he was a flop? Like he was pretty good in bed, but he couldn't quite hit that spot the other guy could. And the longer Kimmy stayed in the kitchen, the more the darkness began to swirl around him.

You know who made her squirt? Yeah, that's right, you got it: Devlin Stone.

Maybe Kimmy'd squirted all over Devlin's massive cock every day this week, getting fucked on her lunch break . . .

There was another person who could have made her squirt before: Kimmy. Her own fingers might have dowsed that well and produced a gusher. That made the most sense. And in fact he was smiling when the bedroom door opened again.

“Hey,” he called out.

“You’re not sleeping?”

“You don’t have to whisper.”

She giggled.

He said, “No, I’m waiting for you.”

Passing the foot of the bed on light feet, she said, “Waiting for some kale kisses?”

He chuckled, wormed deeper under the covers and closed his eyes. “Gross, no, keep away from me. Go brush your teeth.”

She was giggling as she closed herself in the bathroom. She scrubbed her teeth for a few minutes, gargled and spit, came out and shut off the bathroom light. On the way back to the bed, she said, “Yuck, I hate the taste of toothpaste after citrus.”

“Ugh. Orange juice and kale?”

“No—lemon,” she said, slipping in behind him under the sheets, her bare legs touching his bare legs. She curled up against his body and purred, “I get to be the big spoon.”

Her hand slipped over his chest and he clutched it over his heart while she wormed her face against the back of his head, blowing at his hair like it was tickling her nose. She smelled like mint.

Now she whispered, “That was amazing tonight.”

“It was,” he agreed.

“We just have to communicate.”

“Use our grownup words.”

She sighed, a slight happy groan in her throat. “I love you so much, Josh,” she whispered.

And he said what was on his mind: “Gross, why—just ‘cause I made you squirt? I feel so cheap now.”

She said, “Are you sure I did? Did I really . . . do that?” She couldn’t say squirt.

“You did.”

“It felt funny—tickly and good—but I don’t think I . . . Did I?”

“You did, babe. That was the first time?” He waited.

She avoided. She said, “It’s just because it was so . . . dirty. You’re an animal, Josh. I had a long day at work, and I mean . . . like fourteen hours, and I really needed a shower . . .” She chuckled near his ear, making his shoulder raise and his skin go to goose flesh. “You were very into it—you were going to do it no matter what I said, not taking no for an answer . . . and that was . . . that was really hot.”

“Yeah. It was an unexpected turn to my evening.”

She kissed his auricle, snuggled against him.

But he still wasn’t at peace.

“You said he didn’t assault you.”

“Devlin? No.”

“You don’t think that was assault?”

“No, he didn’t fight me. He was just letting me know . . . what he wanted.”

“So gross. I still can’t believe it. Why would he think he could get away with that? . . . You’re married.” He squirmed to face her; she gave him space, then cupped a hand on his neck.

“Some guys . . .” She shrugged.

“I don’t want to get into this again, I’m coming from a different place now, okay, but seriously: Why would you work for a man who held you down and tried to have sex with you?”

She patted his chest. “I can handle Devlin.”

“I know you can. But . . .”

Her expression tightened to serious. “For the money, Josh. To buy us a house.”

They held each other’s gaze; she thumbed his jaw.

But what about all the shoes she was buying, all the expensive suits? Just part of the game? Something she had to do in her new position to fit in? It was pretty sure the Chinese people she would be up against working for Devlin would appreciate seeing her success. Would think less of her showing up in one of the suits she wore at Immigration. The Chinese people she was working with now were nothing like the Chinese people she worked with before at Immigration. But still . . . The more money she spent on extravagances, the longer she would take to save money. No kidding, he bet if he added up what she’d spent on clothes in the last month it could be close to five figures. Devlin had given her an up front and everything, but . . . damn it—he had to stop thinking like this. Of course she needed to buy those clothes. He’d just explained it to himself. It was part of the job, an expectation of the opposition and clients she faced now working with Chinese businesses.

“Okay,” he said and smiled. “I trust you.”

One more thing. She could see it in his face. She said, “What is it?”

“Did you . . .” His eyes wandered, then returned. “Did you wear . . . your lingerie to work—to the meeting?”

She nodded. “I wore it.”

“Why?”

She shrugged a shoulder, but didn't look away. “I like it.”

“It's . . . sexy. It's meant for me. Who else would see it?”

She rolled her eyes up, thinking. “I like . . . I told you I like how I feel when I wear it. Nobody sees it, but I know I'm wearing it, and that makes me . . .” She shrugged her shoulders high, looking for an explanation. “It makes me feel . . .” She looked up, sheepish. “Powerful, I guess. Is that stupid?”

He chuckled, snuffled soft breathy laughter. She looked at him, puzzled. He kissed her forehead. That was good enough. He rolled over, gave her his back. “Okay, big spoon,” he said, throwing a thumb over his shoulder, “hop on.”

Kimmy sighed and cooed, snuggled up to his back, hugged her warm and lean body to his. She hooked an arm around and made a fist over his heart and he covered it with his own hand. She kissed his neck, whispered, “Good night, baby,” and his heart swelled with love and contentment.

“I love you, Kimmy.”

“I love you, too, Josh.”

She breathed wintergreen toothpaste over his cheek and he took it in. She smelled of soap too. He'd sudsed her good in the shower. Got all her nooks and crannies. Something else he did good: made her come hard enough to squirt.

Despite his thorough soaping of her afterward, he swore he could still detect the smell of her sex.

Afterword

Another episode with Kimmy, Josh, and Devlin will be coming soon!—join me on Patreon to read further ahead . . .

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